

DARK PSYCHOLOGY AND MANIPULATION

LEARN THE PRACTICAL USES AND DEFENSES OF MANIPULATION
TO INFLUENCE HUMAN BEHAVIOR THROUGH THE SECRET
TECHNIQUES OF PERSUASION AND MIND CONTROL



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Dark Psychology and Manipulation

*Learn the Practical Uses and
Defenses of Manipulation to
Influence Human Behavior through
the Secret Techniques of Persuasion
and Mind Control*

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Introduction

It is hard to think of psychology as dark. Most people want to believe that they are good people, which means their minds would not have a dark side. They strive to bring good into the world, ignoring their darkest thoughts and hiding their dark secrets. Unfortunately, we can only push these dark thoughts aside for so long.

Pushing your dark thoughts deep into your mind is similar to bottling up negative emotions, eventually, both explode. When you explode with emotions, you might find yourself losing control in the form of crying, yelling, or having a mental breakdown. When your dark side explodes, it is more subtle. Most people don't even realize that they have let their dark side loose.

Some people are always aware of their dark side and use tactics like manipulation in order to fulfill their dark needs. A person who does this might be considered narcissistic.

Do We Have a Dark Side?

No matter how much we try to ignore it or how well we try to hide it, we all have a dark side. Sometimes, you know your dark side and let it come out in the clothes you wear, the makeup you put on, the way you treat people, or the way you isolate yourself from society. Sometimes, you don't realize your dark side comes out in what you say or do.

You should realize that just because you have a dark side does not mean you are a bad person. It does not mean you want to hurt someone or believe people are bad. There are a lot of societal and cultural stereotypes of what it means to have a dark side. Most of these stereotypes come from people who commit crimes, narcissists, Satanists, and other people society categorizes as "bad."

There are positives that can come from a person's dark side. For instance, they might find that they love horror movies which gives them a lot of adrenalin. It is something that helps them relax and stay motivated throughout their day. It is always fun to have your dark side shine during Halloween. People who have a dark side and enjoy this holiday will create some of the best haunted houses or mazes that you go through. Having a dark side is also helpful when you like to be scared.

Your dark side becomes a problem when you want to harm someone physically, mentally or emotionally. It becomes a problem when you want to control their mind through manipulative means in order to improve your life. You don't care what it does to them because you generally don't care about other people. This is when a dark side can become dangerous and criminal.

The Truth About Dark Psychology

One of the biggest reasons people struggle with dark psychology is they don't fully understand what it means. Dark psychology is more than someone's actions and thoughts. It is looking at why people prey on other humans. Like psychology, it is trying to find a reason as to why people think and act the way they do. The only difference is, with dark psychology, it focuses on why a human would purposely harm another human or animal (Nuccitelli, 2006). For example, dark psychology looks at why Adolph Hitler murdered millions of Jews during World War Two. People who study dark psychology ask what made Hitler tick the way he did? Why did Hitler target the Jews?

Dark psychology can also help you understand someone. For example, if you feel that you are being manipulated by your significant other, you can learn about their techniques and why they do this. This can help you not only understand the person but also protect yourself. You can start to counteract your significant other's actions. Of course, this is going to make them angry. However, it is also going to throw them off their game, which is going to give you more leverage.

You might not realize that you are using dark psychology on someone. No matter who you are, you have manipulated a person at one time or another. While this might have been to help them, it is still considered a form of dark psychology. However, it is not truly dark. When you are manipulating someone in order to help them, which is what therapists do with their clients, you are using general psychology. Even though some of the tactics might be dark in nature, many people don't consider this a main

form of dark psychology. It is always important to distinguish between bad and good psychology before you start looking into dark psychology.

To help you distinguish, psychologists state there are four dark personality traits. These traits are commonly found in people who follow dark psychology.

1. Narcissist

Narcissists are probably the most common example of people who take part in dark psychology. They are also described as not only feeling but truly believing they are better than others. They like to be the center of attention and believe they are some of the most important people. Many people feel that a narcissist is delusional in their thinking. While they typically are, they don't care what other people think. What matters to them is what they think and that everyone else goes along with it.

2. Machiavellians

They are known as master manipulators, which is someone who always uses negative manipulation in order to get what they want. You have probably met a Machiavellian at some point in your life and noticed that they cheated you out of something, took credit for your work, bullied you, or simply made you feel worthless. While narcissists are also known to be manipulators, Machiavellians are more thorough at the game. They will also take part in white collar crime once they reach what they want. For example, if someone works their way up to CEO through manipulative techniques just so they can start stealing money from the company, they are a Machiavellian.

3. Daily Sadists

You have probably heard about a murder or another crime in the news lately that made your stomach feel sick. When this happens, you are hearing about an everyday sadist. They are people who want to harm other humans or animals and enjoy doing it. They will often look for jobs where they can take part in this behavior and find a way, usually manipulative, to get away with it. They don't care how they harm someone, how much pain they cause, or even if they kill someone. They take part in these actions because it gives them pleasure.

4. Psychopaths

Many people confuse the difference between sadists and psychopaths because both can get pleasure from harming others. However, psychopaths are often diagnosed with various mental disorder to help explain their behavior. They are also known to be a bit darker when it comes to their actions. While sadists will still feel emotions, which can lead them to not take part in certain behaviors, psychopaths typically do not feel these emotions. The main emotion they feel is the joy they get when they are brutalizing someone.

Psychopaths often don't think their actions through like other dark personalities do. They tend to do whatever is going to make them feel good in the moment. One of the most well-known psychopaths is Charles Manson.

Unfortunately, no matter how much we try, we cannot change the fact that there is dark psychology going on in the world. It is just like there are bad and good people in the world. There is nothing that you can do to get rid of it.

Some people will try to ignore dark psychology in order to live a more peaceful life. This is not something you should do. If you start to ignore

facts of life such as manipulation and crime, you can cause yourself to become trapped in a web created by a narcissist or psychopath. This can lead you down a very dark and dangerous path. You need to become aware that dark psychology exists, so you understand what it is and can protect yourself from it as much as possible.

This also doesn't mean that you need to become anxious about dark psychology. It existed before you were even born. In fact, people don't often study dark psychology so they can protect themselves, however you can do this. They study dark psychology so they can gain an understanding of what makes people like Charles Manson, Ted Bundy, and Adolph Hitler tick. What makes them think that they can get away with their actions? More importantly, what makes other people, regular people who care about others, start to follow their ways and become just as dark and manipulative? For example, the Nazi soldiers, who were under the control of Adolph Hitler. The majority of these soldiers were regular German citizens who once lived and talked to Jewish citizens. They then start to believe what Hitler was saying, which made them turn on people they once considered kind and hardworking citizens.

What Are You Going to Gain?

This book is broken down into three main chapters. The first chapter focuses on manipulation. You will learn about manipulation, what its advantages are, and where it stands on the ethical scale. You will also learn what some of the common traits of a manipulator are. You will learn about manipulation in the workplace and covert emotional manipulation, which is often used in relationships.

The main part of chapter 1 gives you a variety of manipulation techniques. You can use these techniques to help you better understand the mind of a manipulator. At the same time, they will help you learn what to watch out for when you meet someone new and you think they might be trying to manipulate you. Some of the techniques in this book are the fear-relief technique, negative reinforcement, the emotional triangle, gaslighting, smear campaign, creating fake intimacy, and guilt tripping.

At the same time, you will also learn self-defense techniques. These will help you fight off any manipulative techniques that people use against you. For example, you will learn that the more you drive to succeed, the more manipulators will back away from you. This is because an easier target is someone who doesn't have the determination to succeed. People who want to succeed usually have higher self-esteem, which can make them harder to manipulate.

You will also learn that having the right mindset is going to set you apart from your manipulator. This will make it harder for them to

manipulate you into doing something that they want because you are mentally and emotionally strong. You will also learn how keeping a journal, putting focus on them, and ignoring the drama can help you.

This chapter will also let you take a step into looking at dark psychology the way psychologists do. In chapter 1, you will look at why people focus on manipulation. What makes a manipulator tick and want to take control through manipulative means?

Chapter 2 focuses on persuasion. This is a topic that isn't often thought of as dark because people are trying to persuade others all the time. For example, advertisements are trying to persuade you to purchase a product. This isn't doing you any harm; therefore, most people feel it is not considered dark. While they are correct, the reality is, whenever you try to make someone think a certain way for your benefit, it is a bit on the dark psychology side.

Chapter 2 will teach you the key elements of persuasion and what Greek Philosopher Aristotle believed about persuasion with his ethos, pathos, and logos. You will also learn some of the main techniques when it comes to using persuasion, such as liking, foot in the door technique, commitment, feeling that it is your decision, the us vs. them technique, and the curiosity gap. You will also receive techniques which will help you resist the powers of persuasion.

Chapter 3 focuses on mind control. While many of the techniques you learned before are part of mind control, there are many more I did not discuss in the first two chapters. For example, you will learn about embedded commands, meta programs, social pressure, belief changes, rewards and consequences, how they will try to think for you, and behavioral modification. You will also learn that you can unknowingly allow someone to control your mind by how you act. For example, if you

are a rebel, you are more likely to fall victim to mind control. You can also fall victim if you struggle to say “no,” you ask for guidance when it is not needed, and you don’t take care of yourself.

This chapter will also focus on certain ways that will allow you to recognize mind control by paying attention to behaviors. For example, if you find someone mirroring you, they might be trying to understand you so they can open the door to your mind. This is also a way that you can protect yourself from mind control. Mind controllers are also known to be moody and highly critical. You will find that they limit your choices and you might start to feel increasingly isolated from your friends and family.

Like the previous two chapters, you will be able to learn some self-defense techniques against mind controllers. You will learn to recognize the rules they give you and if this is something you want to follow. You will realize that one of the best ways to protect yourself is to remain in contact with your friends and family. On top of this, you will learn that it is important for you to note when a family member or friend tells you that your significant other is not treating you right.

Chapter 1: Manipulation

One of the biggest ways people use dark psychology is through manipulation. This can happen through a variety of ways and in nearly every setting. In fact, someone could be manipulating you and you wouldn't even realize it.

What is Manipulation?

In general, manipulation refers to the skillful controlling, using, or handling of a person or object in order to obtain your underlying motive ("Manipulation", 2019). Everyone will engage in manipulation during their lifetime. However, because they usually do this periodically, people don't tend to notice. People do start to notice manipulation when someone uses it every day, generally more than once a day. At this point, the person is labeled as a manipulator.

Most people don't even realize they are using periodic manipulation because it is so normal. For instance, if you have ever told someone that you are "fine" or "just tired" when they asked you if you were feeling alright, you engaged in periodic manipulation. The reason for this is because, through your answer, you are controlling the person's actions towards you. You might have answered "fine" because you don't want to talk about what is wrong. Therefore, you gave your answer in a way that you keep the person from asking you what is wrong. They might ask you if you are sure, but, unless they know you well or your manipulation did not work, they won't pry.

Good vs. Bad Manipulation

You need to understand that there are good and bad types of manipulation. For example, your significant other who twists words in order to make you feel inferior is using manipulation negatively. A therapist who is asking you specific questions in order to get you to find out an underlying reason for your problem is using manipulation in a positive way.

In other words, a therapist is using manipulation for the client's own good. It is not for the therapist's benefit; it is for their client's benefit.

Is Manipulation Ethical?

Manipulation and ethics are a big debate. While therapists will use manipulation with their clients constantly, they are trained to do it in a positive way. Therapists need to critically think about what questions they will ask their clients so they can further help them. One form of manipulation in your therapist's office is them telling you to sit anywhere when you enter their office. While you might feel this is a form of courtesy, it is a form of manipulation. Where you decide to sit tells your therapist how comfortable you are being there. For example, if you sit close to the door, they know you aren't comfortable. If you sit near where your therapist sits, you are believed to be a bit more comfortable. This is an ethical form of manipulation because it is not hurting you. It is a way the therapist gets to know you.

The bottom line is, manipulation is ethical if it is used to the benefit of others. There is no list of ethics when it comes to manipulation. There are people who state it is never ethical to use anywhere. There are other people that believe it is ethical, depending on its use.

Advantages of Manipulation

There are several advantages of manipulation. Of course, this also depends upon how you use it. For instance, therapists will see different advantages than someone using manipulation for their self-gain. However, these different ways can also give manipulators the same results.

1. You can receive the results you want.

Manipulation is mind control. When you are successful in your efforts, you are able to see the results that you want. For example, if you want your child to start completing their chores, you will create a chore chart which lists their chores. You will give them a sticker each time they complete one of their chores. When they have reached so many stickers, you give them a prize.

Another common example of manipulators is in the workplace. Many people find themselves trying to work up toward the President or CEO of a company, while many manipulate their way to the top. You might also have a co-worker who manipulates other people into doing their work yet will take the credit for it.

2. You are able to help someone.

Therapists aren't the only people who use manipulation to help someone. Your friends and family may positively manipulate you in trying to help you. For example, while you might be in a manipulative relationship, your friends and family might be trying to manipulate you out of the relationship.

3. You are able to control someone.

People like control and manipulation is one of the ways to gain control. There are several ways manipulators gain control of you, such as isolating you from other people or setting rules that you have to follow, or you receive their wrath. Manipulators will often target people they know they can control, such as people with poor self-esteem or a negative self-image. The main reason for this is it makes their job of trying to manipulate the person easier.

4. You are able to feel better about yourself.

Another reason many master manipulators follow their ways is that it makes them feel better about themselves. Unless they are narcissistic, manipulators can have low self-esteem which they easily hide through their manipulative strategies. Therefore, by making someone feel worse about themselves, they are able to feel better.

This advantage can also work in a more positive way. If you use manipulation to help someone, you will see that they are becoming happier and able to work through their problems. Furthermore, they know they are not alone. When we help people, we naturally start to feel better about ourselves.

Personality Traits of a Manipulator

If you have ever heard the term “master manipulator,” you might have an idea of a few personality traits of a manipulator. Most manipulators, especially people who are using it for their own benefit, share similar characteristics. One factor to note is that there are traits that are easily noticeable and traits manipulators will hide well.

Manipulators Will Pressure You

A manipulator will pressure you into making a decision before you are ready. They might start by doing this subtly at first and then increase their efforts. Their goal is to get you to cave as this will give them what they want.

Manipulators Are Experts at the Silent Treatment

If there is one main way to make a manipulator mad it is to not give in. When a manipulator starts to feel threatened by your emotional and mental strength, they will resort to isolating you. For example, they might refuse to allow you to answer a question or completely ignore you.

Manipulators use this tactic to remain powerful. They want to make sure they assert their dominance.

Manipulators Will Bully You

Manipulators will do whatever they can to remain powerful, including bullying behavior. They will do whatever they can to shake your confidence as they want to make sure you don't feel emotionally and mentally stronger than them.

They will take part in this behavior anywhere, however, they often become more of a bully in public. This is because it allows them to embarrass you to the point you won't want to socialize with many people.

Manipulators Will Never Admit Their Faults

Manipulators will find someone else to blame, such as their parent, significant other, friends, and even children. They will also make up excuses when someone notices their weaknesses. For example, they might say that they didn't know certain information because someone never told them.

Manipulators Will Test Your Boundaries

No matter how strongly you discuss your boundaries with a manipulator, they will still test them. While they will act like they are sorry at first, by telling you that they didn't realize this was a boundary, they don't feel this way. Testing your boundaries is a great way for a manipulator to learn what you will and will not put up with. They want to learn your breaking points, so they know what they can and cannot do right away. This doesn't mean that they won't cross your breaking points. They will just wait to do this until they have you within their webs.

Manipulators Don't Validate Your Feelings

Manipulators don't care about you as a person, they care about how they can use you to get what they want. Therefore, they aren't going to spend time trying to make you feel better, ask you what is wrong, how your day went, or validate your feelings.

As humans, we need to have our emotions validated in order to work through them and maintain a healthy mindset. By not validating your emotions, manipulators are able to keep stronger control over you because you will start to lose your confidence, self-esteem, and self-image. You will become so overwhelmed with emotions, most of them negative, you will become depressed and could stop caring about yourself. You might also stop talking to your friends and family. In general, you lose your interest in life.

This gives a manipulator the upper hand because you are more likely to do what they say. You will act how they want you to act. Even if you don't feel it is right, they will start to get you to believe that they are the only ones who care about you. Of course, this will further isolate you from anyone else you know and used to hang out with.

Manipulators are Compulsive Liars

Manipulators are also known as compulsive liars. This is because they often distort facts in order to make them seem better than you or the best out of everyone. For a manipulator, it doesn't matter if the facts prove them wrong, they literally do not believe the facts.

However, their lying goes beyond facts. They will also use half-truths or withhold important information from you. This will allow them to maintain their leverage over you. For example, if you are working on a project with a manipulator, they will try to get information from their supervisor or project

manager when you are not there. They will then inform you of what they were told but leave out a lot of information. They can then use this left-out information against you. They could lower your confidence in the project because you don't know everything your partner knows, or they could embarrass you in front of other people.

Types of Manipulation

There are several types of manipulation because it can often depend on where the manipulator is or who they are manipulating. For example, there are some manipulators who focus on workplace tactics while others will manipulate their significant other. Of course, there are manipulators who will use their tactics no matter where they are or who they are with.

Covert Emotional Manipulation

Covert emotional manipulation is a part of any form of manipulation. However, it is stronger in people who are known as “master manipulators” or people who will manipulate anyone in order to get anything they want. It is not as strong in manipulation tactics people use when they tell someone they are fine, even though something is wrong.

At the base of manipulation is working to change the way people feel and think, which is covert emotional manipulation. They focus on your conscious awareness in order to control you. Because of this, people don't often realize that they are being manipulated.

First, the manipulator will get you to trust them. Then, they will start to control the way you feel, think, and perceive situations. This will happen slowly as they don't want you to catch on to the manipulation. Once they feel that your emotions and thoughts are in their hands, they will start to tear apart your confidence. A master manipulator knows they have to lower your self-esteem in order to control you the way they want to. They will also work to take away your identity, which allows you to fully become theirs.

While they are trying to break you down emotionally and mentally, they will also try to keep you away from your family and friends. One of the biggest reasons for this is people who knew you before they came into your life are a threat to them. Your family and friends will notice a change in you, and they won't like it. They will try to find out why you are changing and, typically very quickly, they point their fingers at the manipulator. When this happens, your friends and family will do what they can to try to see what this person is doing to you and how you are being treated. This is one of the most common signs of manipulation in relationships.

Of course, you will start to notice a change within yourself. Unfortunately, it is usually after the manipulator has had control over you. You start to notice yourself change when you begin to feel different. You might notice you have anxiety, you are depressed, having trouble sleeping, you struggle trusting people you once trusted, and you have become increasingly isolated ("About Covert Emotional Manipulation", n.d.).

For most people, it is hard to spot the signs of manipulators. This is especially true for people who suffer from manipulation from their significant other. In general, it is hard to spot certain signs of manipulation. Furthermore, it is often harder to spot these behaviors from people who you love and believe love you back. In relationships, people often turn a "blind eye" to their significant other's manipulative ways because they see them as faults. We work to understand the faults of each other in relationships.

While you will want to notice the personality traits of a manipulator discussed previously, there are a lot of other signs when it comes to manipulation in relationships. This is because manipulators often let down their guard a bit when they are at home. They are in their comfort zone and believe they can do anything, and you won't protect yourself or try to change it because you are too weak.

1. They will start a fight with you over something minor.

Manipulators need to win, and this is frequently displayed in their relationships, especially their romantic ones. Therefore, you may notice that if you are having a minor disagreement with your significant other, they will turn it into a fight so that you allow them to win. They want you to give up and do whatever they want to do.

2. They are great secret keepers.

While they don't like it when you keep any secret from them, they can keep anything they want from you. Furthermore, they don't have to tell you anything they are doing or where they are going. This simply doesn't matter to you. In other words, what they do is their business and you need to mind your own.

However, if you treat them the same way, they will start a fight, tell you that you don't love them, or become angry. This is because if they don't know everything about you, they are losing their control. They are also able to keep control away from you by not letting you know their secrets.

3. Their actions and words don't match.

Manipulators realize that in order to keep you in their control, they need to sometimes give you what you want. While this can come in the form of gifts, they will usually focus on telling you what you want to hear. However, they will not follow through with their words. For example, if you are feeling lonely and don't want your significant other to go out with their friends again, you will ask them to stay with you. You will ask for time alone or to go with them. They will give you an excuse for why tonight won't work, but then make a promise to spend more time with you or both of you will do something another night. Unfortunately, they will rarely follow through with their promise.

4. They will act like the victim.

There is always a time that you are going to argue with your significant other or try to stand up for yourself. This not only happens in the beginning but throughout the relationship. When it does, the manipulator is going to play the role of the victim. They will twist your words to make it seem like you are the one who is doing something wrong. While you might not agree with this perception at first, they will continue to use their emotions to persuade you to believe them.

Manipulation in the Workplace

Many people deal with workplace manipulation at some point in their career. Sometimes it is because one of their co-workers is a manipulator while other times it is everyday forms of manipulation. For example, a co-worker manipulates you into helping them with their task or gets you to do their task. They only do this because they don't like this specific responsibility.

Sometimes you will start to notice your supervisor is a manipulator. Unfortunately, this is highly common in the workplace as many supervisors have used manipulation to get their position, especially if they worked themselves up the ladder. However, you should never assume your supervisor is manipulative. If they are, they will typically demonstrate signs of being a manipulator, such as bullying, blaming others, guilt-tripping their staff, giving staff the silent treatment, and distorting facts.

One way you know if you work with a manipulator is by the way you are treated. Manipulators need to make sure you know your place, meaning you are beneath them. Therefore, they will often make sarcastic comments that make you feel inferior. For example, you come to work one day in

professional attire that is more casual than your company usually wears. Instead of a white shirt and a suit, you are wearing a white shirt with slacks. When your co-worker notices your attire, they start to belittle your clothes, making fun of your lower-paying income and that you can't afford nicer clothes.

Manipulation Techniques

So far, I have briefly talked about a few manipulation techniques through the personality traits and signs of a manipulator. However, it is important to be thorough about the techniques because there are dozens of techniques that manipulators use. Sometimes, they make up their own techniques as they go through their job or relationship as it helps them gain and keep control.

Foot in the Door Technique

The foot in the door technique is probably one of the most well-known forms of manipulation. It is also considered to be one of the oldest. It dates back to when people use to go door to door trying to sell their product. Of course, the salespeople took the phrase a bit more literally than manipulators. While salespeople would literally place their foot in front of the door so the homeowner couldn't close it on them, manipulators take more of a mental and emotional stance towards this technique.

The first step manipulators use is by asking for a small favor or “breaking the ice” through a small conversation. This helps the manipulators build a rapport with their target. For example, if they are trying to find a significant other, they will find a way to become compatible with their target. They will then ask the person questions about what they like and mention they enjoy the same things.

This technique is often how people get to know each other in a social setting. For example, have you ever been sitting at a club or coffee shop when someone came up to you and started small talk? They might have

stated it was a busy night or a nice day. You might have agreed in some way, whether verbally or through your actions. Giving a reaction is letting the person keep their foot in the door. While you are probably just trying to be polite, depending on their motive, they see it as a step into your life.

Negative Reinforcement

Master manipulators will often use a tactic called negative reinforcement in order to get you to stop doing something they don't like. This could be anything from going out with your friends, going back to college, or getting a job. Typically, they don't like anything that gives them a loss of control and threatens their environment.

When you start to do something they don't like, they will do something that you don't like. This is the first step of negative reinforcement. They will continue to use negative reinforcement, along with other tactics to try to get you to stop doing what they don't like. Once they have manipulated you to stop, they will then stop.

Another way that negative reinforcement works is when the manipulator starts to do something you don't like because you won't do what they want you to do. In order to get the manipulator to stop doing what you don't like, you have to do what they ask of you, even if you don't like it.

The main reason negative reinforcement is used is that it makes it more likely that you will do what they ask of you in the future without hesitation. This is especially true for manipulators who use any type of abuse to get you to stop doing something or to listen to them.

The Emotional Triangle

The emotional triangle is similar to a love triangle; however, it is used against you. The manipulator will use it in order to get you to do what they want. They will create a triangle with themselves, you, and a third person who is not directly involved in your relationship.

The manipulator will not hide the fact that they are interested in the third person, even if they aren't in truth. They will flirt with the person in front of you and even show affection toward the person. Sometimes they will use certain affections that you like, whether it is rubbing the person's back or giving them a hug.

While it might be obvious, they like the other person, they will deny any type of affection in a confrontation. They will blame you, telling you that it is your insecurities and low self-esteem which is making you believe this.

The main goal of the emotional triangle is you become insecure about your relationship, which means you will work harder to make your significant other happy. You will do what they ask, even if you don't want to or feel uncomfortable taking on the assignment.

Establishing Similarities

The foot in the door technique can often lead manipulators into another technique where they establish similarities. This is similar to the previous example; however, it is usually stronger than asking a few questions. For example, the manipulator might learn through observation or from a friend that you like a certain coffee shop. Therefore, they will decide to run into you at the coffee shop, where they discuss how much you both enjoy the location and the coffee.

Manipulators will also mirror your actions. They will notice if you are putting your elbows on the table and do the exact same thing. They will

notice your hand gestures and how often you smile. They will then mirror these actions as well. This is a psychological tactic that reaches into your subconscious mind. It makes you feel like you can trust the person because you feel more connected, even if you don't realize they are mirroring your actions and behaviors.

Fear-Relief Technique

Fear is a strong emotion and can often cause us to react in extreme ways. People are typically uncomfortable with fear, which means they will want to find a way to ease their fears. Because of this, manipulators commonly use the fear-relief technique as it allows them to gain the trust of their target by using emotion.

This technique is heavily used by manipulative people who create a fear in you, so they can give you relief, which makes you more likely to listen to their requests next time. For example, if you and your significant other have a disagreement, which makes you leave the house and go for a drive or to a friend's house to vent. You come home and your significant other is gone. You wait a couple of hours and when they still don't return, you call their cell phone. They don't pick up. Another hour later, you try calling them again but receive their voicemail. At this point, you start to become anxious about the situation. You have left dozens of text messages and they don't answer their phone. You start to worry that something has happened to them. A couple of hours later they send you a text that says they are on their way home and everything is fine.

When you confront your significant other as they walk in the door about what they were doing, they respond that you left, so they could too. They

then tell you that as long as you do something like that to them, they can do it too.

Manipulators Will Put You on the Defense

Manipulators like to reach into your emotions because they are powerful. When you react with your emotions, you stop thinking clearly, make irrational decisions, and have trouble remaining calm. This is how a manipulator wants you to react because conversations where you think rationally and are calm, do not go in their favor.

Therefore, manipulators use a tactic where they will put you on the defense. This means that you will feel like you need to explain yourself. You have to defend how you feel, who you are, and what you believe. This is one of the strongest signs of manipulation, but one that people don't often notice because it becomes common.

It is important to realize that just because you find you are explaining something you believe to your significant other, doesn't mean you are in a manipulative relationship. There are many times in a relationship that you might find yourself explaining why you support a cause your significant other doesn't or why you find something is fun when your partner doesn't. In a healthy relationship, you will find yourself explaining your beliefs and thoughts when your significant other wants to understand you in order to support you. You will also ask your significant other to explain themselves so you can treat them the same way. In a manipulative relationship, your significant other will always put you on the defense, no matter what your action was. The only time you might not find yourself on the defense is if they approve of your behavior.

The Gaslighting Technique

Gaslighting is phrasing the manipulator will use repeatedly in order to make you believe a situation you remember is wrong. Some of the most common phrases include “You can’t be serious,” “I never said that” “You don’t remember it correctly,” “Are you crazy?” and “You are imagining it.” While you might feel that you are right, the manipulator will continue to stand by what they say, believe, or even give you their version of the situation. They might mix gaslighting with other tactics in order for you to start questioning yourself. They will continue to break you down through gaslighting or simply find a way to end the conversation.

Gaslighting is a very dangerous tactic because it is used to distort your reality. If it is used enough, you might start to feel that you are crazy, or you do imagine all these situations. This will mentally and emotionally break you down even further, which will allow the manipulator to gain the upper hand as you start to distrust your own thoughts, emotions, and abilities. You start to distrust your reality, making you believe that you are not seeing what you see, and you do not actually hear what you hear.

Traumatic One Trial Learning Technique

Manipulators are good with putting on an act. They don’t always mean what they say or how they feel, but they will get you to believe that they do. One technique that manipulators use to get you to listen to them better so they can keep you under control easier is called traumatic one trial learning.

When a manipulator uses this technique, they will become angry when they feel you have done something wrong. For example, if you come home later than you said you would, your significant other might yell, make you

feel ashamed, or become verbally abusive. They will act in a way they know will make you fear their anger, so you are less likely to do something like that again.

Manipulators Will Refuse to Discuss Certain Topics or Behaviors

For a manipulator, this is often looked at as a defense mechanism. They will absolutely refuse to answer any questions that put them in a bad light or put their behavior in question. While they will try other tactics, such as excuses, making you feel guilty, or blaming you, if nothing else works for them they will directly end the conversation. Of course, if you continue to try to push them for answers, the way the manipulator will act varies. They could become violent, which is why people always suggest that you need to watch their temper and behavior before you continue to push them for answers. If they are getting to the point where they might physically assault you, it is time to step away and leave.

Gossiping

Even if you don't like to gossip, you might find yourself doing this while someone is trying to manipulate you. This is because it is often a tactic a manipulator will use to try to gain the upper hand. They will gossip for two main reasons. First, it is because they want to get you to believe that certain people are not the people you want to hang out with. No one wants to be friends with a bully or someone who purposely wants to hurt someone. They will make up stories about your friends, family, or someone else that you know.

Second, this gives you two a connection. We all do this so think about the last time you gossiped with a friend or someone else. Didn't you share a connection because you were thinking the same thing, especially about someone you didn't care for? Manipulators understand this, so they will use this technique in order to form a connection with you.

Third, they can use this gossiping time against you at a later date. Manipulators make note of pretty much everything you do and say. Therefore, when they want to try to break you down whether it is through your confidence or another means, they might bring you back to this moment. They might tell you that they didn't think you were a horrible person but should have known when you started to gossip about people. Even if they were the ones who initiated the conversation, they will blame you. They will get you to believe that it was all your doing and that you are the reason your friends don't like you anymore. This is a tactic that many manipulators use in order to make you feel isolated.

Manipulators Want You to Feel Rejected

Sometimes manipulators will wait until the perfect moment before they try to help you. For example, they might sit back while you are both at the bar and wait for someone to reject you. When this happens, they will quickly come to you and try to make you feel better. They might tell you that the person was dumb to reject you because you are beautiful. They will try to build up your confidence so you will start to believe them and allow them into your life.

Smear Campaign Technique

There are times when a manipulator can't break you down emotionally and mentally to the extent they would like. This means that you don't allow them to destroy your confidence and self-image. You might realize that they are manipulators, or you might not believe them for other reasons.

But just because they can't break you down, doesn't mean that won't try a different tactic. The smear campaign is when the manipulator will chip away at your image in a more social setting. They will start slandering your public image and ruin your reputation. They will do this through a variety of ways, such as bullying, sarcasm, or making up stories about you that portray you negatively. They work to label you as the toxic person and get people to believe that they are the victim.

Creating Fake Intimacy

One of the first steps a manipulator will take is getting you to trust them. This will allow them into your life a bit easier. It will also psychologically tell you that you can let your guard down as this person will not hurt you.

The best way manipulators do this is through a false sense of intimacy. They will tell you something private, sometimes stating they have never told anyone this before. Many manipulators will use emotions in order to gain your trust. For example, a manipulator might tell you about a time he was abused as a child or growing up with an alcoholic parent. These stories can be full of details that will make you feel sorry for them. While some manipulators might tell you a real story, some will make something up. They might tell the same story to all of their victims.

It is important to remember that manipulators will continue to try to gain your trust. For instance, if you don't trust people easily because you have been through a manipulative relationship before, they will continue to

build up your trust. One fact to remember about manipulators is when they have a target, they have a lot of patience. They will do what they need to do in order to gain your trust. They won't often try for a few days to a couple of months and leave you alone. They don't move to another target easily, especially when they want a romantic relationship.

Unreasonable to a Reasonable Request

Another strategy that manipulators use is when they ask you to do something. First, they will ask you to do an unreasonable request, one that they know you will struggle to accomplish. Then, they will follow this request up with a more reasonable request, one they believe you can accomplish.

In reality, people do this often in their lives. It is not just “master manipulators” that are going to use this technique. However, they will think more thoroughly when it comes to their requests. Manipulators will also know that you can't perform the first request, meaning you will probably refuse to do the request. Therefore, their second request will be what they wanted you to do in the first place. They know that you will accept this request because you can do it and you don't want to refuse a request twice in a row.

This is often a technique a manipulator will use when you can make a comparison. For example, your significant other wants to purchase a new vehicle. He wants to buy the red Grand Am for \$16,500. However, he knows you will refuse because this will take about a five-year loan and you just took out a loan for a new van. Therefore, your significant other continues to scope around the lot and finds a new Rav4 which is priced at \$22,500. He decides to tell you he wants to purchase the Rav4 first, which

he knows you will refuse. Then he shows you the Grand Am. While this price is still a little high, you feel it is much better than the first vehicle.

Through using this type of strategy, your significant other has managed to make swaying you toward agreeing to the purchase of the Grand Am easier. Because you know the Grand Am is \$6,000 cheaper, it seems like a more reasonable request.

Attentively Listen

Listening is a tactic that manipulators often use. This is because it often works in their favor. Think about how important you feel when someone is closely listening to you. You start to feel like they truly care, and you start to trust them. Listening opens the door for a manipulator to step into your world.

It's important to realize that manipulators are listening to you, but often not because they truly care what you are saying. It is because they get to know you this way. They learn your hobbies, what your interests are, your career, who your friends are, how close you are to your family, and so much more. They do listen to most of what you share, but it's so they can use it against you. For example, if they notice that you aren't close to your family and that they live far away, the manipulator will know that cutting you off from your family or limiting contact is going to be easier. However, if they learn that you are extremely close to one of your friends and live in the same neighborhood, cutting you off from this friend is going to be tricky, if not almost impossible.

Manipulators Remain Unpredictable

Many psychologists believe that a manipulator's brain is wired a certain way. This is because the way they think is different from the way many other people think. For example, a manipulator knows that in order to keep their agenda hidden from their significant other, co-worker, family, friends, or anyone else they have to make sure no one catches on to their behavioral patterns.

Manipulators might catch on to you feeling that they are becoming boring or feel you are catching on to their patterns. When this happens, they will switch gears quickly, doing something unpredictable to leave you guessing about their behavior.

Staying unpredictable will also make you feel that they are fun and exciting. This will make you want to hang out with them and learn to trust them. This is another way that manipulators get you to open the door for them so they can become a part of your life.

This is why manipulators tend to get some of the best and most unique gifts. When they are in a romantic relationship, they don't often go for regular gifts. Instead, they will give their significant other something more personalized, such as a book of poems, a gift card, a book, or music.

Manipulations Create Distractions

Creating a distraction is a common form of manipulation that many people use, such as political parties, public personalities, and governmental leaders. This is a common technique used when someone wants to divert your attention away from the main issue. They will create a distraction on a smaller issue and makes this out to be the larger problem. This will cause you to pay attention to the distraction, allowing the manipulator to do what they want to.

Manipulators Will Make You Feel Obligated

Manipulators are quick to do you a favor. This because they are trying to get you to feel like you are indebted to them. Think about it, when someone does something for you, don't you feel like you need to return the favor? After all, it is only common courtesy, correct?

While you might feel this way, a manipulator is going to see an avenue for them to trap you into doing something for them, whether you will truly want to or not. For example, your friend bought you tickets to the concert you wanted to go to but couldn't afford. A few months later, your friend asks you to do something for them. While their request makes you a bit uncomfortable you agree because you remember they purchased those tickets and didn't ask you to pay them back. Therefore, you owe them a favor.

The trick that many manipulators will use is they won't ask you for a favor right away. They will wait for the right opportunity to ask you for a favor. Another trick that they will use is they will psychologically make you feel obligated to them. While they won't directly state you owe them, they might say something like "Worry about it when I need help" or "I know you would do the same for me, no reason to thank me." They won't say something like "It isn't a big deal, don't worry about it."

The Guilty Technique

There are a lot of ways manipulative techniques can affect you negatively, one of these is guilt. In fact, when a manipulator makes you feel guilty, they are affecting you in more than one way because of what guilt does to your mind and body.

1. Guilt changes your personality.

Many people don't realize how much influence guilt has on their personality, especially when they live with the feeling for a long time. This commonly happens when they are in a manipulative relationship. Guilt changes them personally by not allowing them to feel like they are the person they used to be. If they had high self-esteem, they do not suffer from poor self-esteem. On the other hand, you might feel you are the same person, but other people will notice a change in you. Usually, they notice that you are not as happy, patient, or believe in yourself like you used to. You might also start to be judgmental or easily irritated.

2. You become affected by guilt on a physical level.

With this technique, manipulators are trying to get you to do something through making you feel guilty for not doing it or doing what they didn't like. For example, a manipulator would make you feel guilty for going out with your friends and not staying home with them. They will also make you feel guilty for not cooking the right meals the right way, not doing chores a certain way, or not making them happy as this is your job as their significant other.

They Will Tap into Your Imposter Syndrome

Most humans find themselves falling victim to the imposter syndrome throughout their lives, no matter how confident they are. The imposter syndrome is when you believe that your accomplishments are fake. That you don't truly deserve them, and you doubt yourself. While you might not always act like this towards every accomplishment, you may question yourself every now and then.

Manipulators love the imposter syndrome as it makes their jobs easier. When they find someone that is questioning their abilities or accomplishments, they will use this to either get you emotionally attached to them or to break you down. If you just met them, they will tell you that you did deserve the recognition, which will make you more comfortable with them. But, if you know them, they will use this time to tell you that you didn't deserve the recognition, you are not as good as other people believe. They might go so far to tell you exactly what you are asking yourself, that you are a fraud, that you don't have the skills, and that you aren't that important.

Manipulators Will Try to Silence You

Manipulators don't easily give up when they find someone fighting against their techniques. This just means they need to up their game, or as some people say, put you in your place. They will do this through a variety of means from verbally and emotionally abusing you to physically abusing you. They might also do this in more subtle ways, such as giving you the silent treatment or another form of punishment.

They might include anchoring in their attempts to gain control of you. For example, if they don't like something you do, they will become hostile. However, if they like something that you do, they will give you affection. They will always become hostile or give you affection every time you exhibit the behavior and feel an emotion.

Another way they will do this is when you are out in public. They will watch you closely to see what you are saying and how you say it. If you cross the line, they will come closer to you in order to give you a warning, which will often put you back in your place. This is one of the biggest ways

they keep you in their grip. Even when people realize that they are in a manipulative relationship, it is often hard to leave because they are silenced by their manipulators. At the same time, they feel they have lost the support of their friends and family because their significant other isolated them. In general, a lot of techniques that manipulators use can lead to silencing you.

The Manipulator's Problems Are Always More Important

In order to gain your trust and affection, the manipulator might make your problems seem important. However, this will quickly diminish as time goes on, usually because the manipulator has been able to get you into their web.

While you might sometimes feel your significant other pushes your problems aside here and there during your relationship, a manipulator will do it all the time. They also won't care if you mention it to them, whereas another person who isn't trying to manipulate you would.

This is a very important sign that you are in a manipulative relationship or one where your emotional needs are not met. The problem with your emotional needs being pushed to the side, is this is going to damage your confidence, self-image, and many other factors within yourself. Of course, this is what a manipulator wants as this means he is able to control you easier. But this is also a way that you can take note that you need to leave a relationship.

Empty Words and Intentionally Forgetting

Manipulators are quick to make promises or commitments to you. They might agree that they will do something with you one night, but never follow through with it. This is a common tactic they use known as intentionally forgetting.

It is important to remember that when manipulators tell you they love you, they want to be with you, they support you, they won't hurt you, or they will do anything to make you happy they are lying. They are using empty words which mean a lot to you, but nothing to them. Therefore, when they intentionally forget to follow through with a promise, they don't feel bad as they never meant to follow through with the promise.

They also don't care how this has made you feel. They might act like they feel guilty or care that they hurt you, but once again, they are just saying words they know you want to hear. Unless their words are going to benefit them in any way, they do not mean what they say.

Manipulators Will Learn Your Key Phrases

Everyone has certain phrases or words which will lead them to take action. For example, someone who is against racism will pay more attention to a conversation or even when the words "racism" or "inequality" are used. This is because they are passionate about this topic. Furthermore, if they are a social advocate, they want to know what is going on so they can find out how they can help.

Manipulators will learn your keywords, so they know when or when not to say them. If they want you to do something, they will more likely tie their request in with your keywords. If they don't want you to do something, they won't use the keywords.

Of course, there are words that tend to be keywords for nearly everyone. For example, most people feel certain emotions when they hear the words “love,” “trust,” “hope,” and “security.” This is because these words often fill us with the positive emotions that our bodies crave. Everyone needs to feel these words in their life. Therefore, when a manipulator uses these words, you are more likely to feel comfortable and trust them. You feel that they are a good person and someone you can let your guard down with.

Shame

Shame is used in the same way guilt is used. Manipulators will try to make you feel ashamed of your actions, so you don’t take part in them again. They also might make you feel ashamed for not doing what they wanted you to do. For example, if they didn’t want you to go meet your friend for lunch but you did. When you come home, the manipulator might make use of words and phrases to shame you into feeling you chose the wrong decision. They might tell you “You must feel like you are full. I am still trying to figure out what I can eat in this house” or “Can we spend some quality time together now?”

This is one of the most emotionally useful techniques for manipulators because shame is an incredibly powerful emotion. Shame can not only make us feel guilty for what we did, but it can make us feel like we are not worthy. It can make us feel like we do not deserve respect, we are humiliated, and we victimized the manipulator.

Psychologists state that shame is the worst feeling for a human because there is no other emotion that affects them more (Birch, 2014). This is because shame leaves deep emotional wounds. It also makes you feel that

you did something in order to hurt your relationship, even if you simply went out to eat with a friend.

Moving Goal Post Technique

By now, you realize that a manipulator never truly has your best interest in mind. They might act as they do, and you might believe they do. However, they are also constantly trying to move closer towards their goal post, which is their ultimate target of control.

To do this a manipulator knows they have to act like they are your best friend, they love you, want to help you, and want to give you everything you ever dreamed of. But they will also spend a bit of time criticizing you and chipping away at your self-esteem and self-image as this moves them closer to their goal. While you will notice some of the criticism, you don't think too much about the manipulator trying to harm you. Instead, you feel that they are trying to help you become a better person.

Self Defense Against Manipulation

With so many manipulation techniques, you might feel it is hard to establish self-defense against them. However, there are a variety of self-defense techniques that you can use which will work on several manipulation strategies.

Keep a Journal of Your Conversations

There is usually some type of signs which send hints that someone is trying to manipulate them. Of course, these are not always easy to spot, unless you have been in the situation before or understand manipulation.

One strategy you can do if you feel that someone is manipulating you is to keep a journal of what is said. You can write down your conversations or things they randomly say to you. At the same time, you can also write down what they do.

While this might seem like an unconventional thing to do, it can help you observe what is truly going on because manipulators work at an emotional level. This is often hard to spot, especially if you already lack confidence in yourself.

You can also include how the situation or words stated made you feel. You might find a connection between what the manipulator states and how you feel. For example, you might find that your self-image is starting to decrease. When you notice this, it is a sign that you need to stay away from the person or get out of the relationship as quickly as possible.

Confront Manipulators About Their Behavior

This is going to be easier with some people than others. For example, if the manipulator is your supervisor and you need your job, you might not directly confront them. You also might struggle to confront your significant other, especially if they have lowered your self-esteem. However, confronting the manipulator is a great way to let them know you understand their behavior and you will not stand for it.

If you take this approach, you want to be aware of the other strategies they could use against you. For instance, they might try to create a distraction or try to play the victim. They also might blame someone else for their behavior or tell you that you are imagining everything.

When you confront a manipulator, you need to be firm. You need to be completely convinced and understand that they will try to manipulate you as they don't want other people to catch on to their behavior. You also need to be cautious because some manipulators can get passive aggressive or violent.

Put the Focus on Manipulators

Along with confronting the manipulator, you can also put the focus on them. You can do this by asking a variety of provoking questions about their motive. You want to try to find out why they are acting the way they do, which is the basis of dark psychology. Some of the questions you can ask are "Do you feel that you are being reasonable?" "What am I going to get out of this?" "Is this really being helpful?" "So, you expect me to (state their request)."

Through asking questions like these, you are showing the manipulator what they are doing. If they aren't a master manipulator and didn't mean to take part of that behavior, they will be remorseful or change their request. However, if they are a master manipulator, they will think of other techniques to turn this around on you. They will try to act like the victim, such as asking "Why are you attacking me?" or defending themselves by saying "I am just trying to help, I don't appreciate being attacked like this."

Continue to Succeed

Manipulators don't want other people to succeed. This creates a threat to them. Therefore, the more you succeed, the more you will push away a manipulator.

Your ability to believe in yourself and continue to succeed is going to depend on how long you have known the manipulator and how close you are to them. For example, it will be a lot harder to stay motivated and work hard to succeed if you have been emotionally beaten down by the manipulator. If you have just met them, you will be able to continue to push toward your success without too much trouble.

Of course, having the mindset of believing you can accomplish your dreams and people supporting you will help you eliminate the manipulator through your success. Therefore, if you need to talk to someone in order to get mentally and emotionally stronger, this is what you do.

Don't Become Emotionally Attached

While sometimes we get trapped by a manipulator because we didn't know their personality, other times we know that they are manipulators but

still need to keep in contact because they are co-workers or family. When this is the situation, you need to protect yourself in a different way because you can't simply ignore them. Therefore, many people suggest that you do your best to not become emotionally attached.

This is going to be harder for some people than others. If you are a more emotional person, you will struggle to keep from becoming emotionally attached as your relationships are based on emotion.

One way to do this is to make sure they are aware of your boundaries. You will also need to make sure you stick to your boundaries. Manipulators don't care if they cross your boundaries, so you need to protect yourself. If you see they are crossing a line, tell them so. Don't fall for any of their techniques and don't back down.

Don't Feed Them Drama

One of the biggest factors that a manipulator thrives on is drama. This is why they will often disagree with someone or something which will cause people to react. Therefore, one of the best ways you can stop a manipulator in their tracks is by telling them "you are right."

Manipulators are not used to people agreeing with them, so when you do, it is going to leave them speechless. This will also create a threat to them that might make them want to leave you alone. They might feel, especially if you do this right away, that they can't trap you with their techniques.

This does not mean they won't try. Manipulators also thrive on trying to get people into the web. However, letting them win the argument, even if it bothers your ego a bit, is a lot better than falling victim to their traps.

Tell the Manipulator That You Will “Think About It”

When the manipulator has a request, they want to know the answer right away. Therefore, when you say something like “I will think about it” or “Maybe, we will see.” They will not be happy with this answer. They might walk away in anger, ask you why you need to think about it or try to persuade you into doing what they want you to do.

What this tactic does for you is it buys you time. This will allow you to distance yourself from the manipulator. This means that you might not have to deal with the request or manipulator again, or at least until they come back. This will also allow you to really think about what you were asked to do. You can weigh the pros and cons and decide what the right decision for you will be.

Have the Right Mindset

Another way to eliminate a manipulator from your life is to have a strong mindset. You want to make sure that you feel confident in your abilities to stop them from using techniques against you. You also want to make sure your self-esteem and self-image is positive. At the same time, you want to understand the ways they will manipulate you.

You need to understand their techniques in order to combat them. You need to understand that they probably won't stop with just one technique. They will more than likely use a few in hopes that they can start to break you down.

The more you remain strong, the more likely the manipulator will leave you alone. Manipulators won't spend a lot of time trying to use different

techniques if you continuously push them away, call them out on their behavior, and continue to believe in yourself.

Meditate

Many people don't realize how much meditation can help. Meditation is not only meant to keep you calm, but it also works to keep you positive and feeling good about yourself. When you feel this way, you will find it easier to eliminate the negativity from your life, which means manipulators.

Meditation is basic and you don't need to put aside a lot of time. You can schedule in about ten minutes out of your day for meditation. Find a time and place where you can be alone and uninterrupted. You also want it to be quiet so you can concentrate on eliminating the negativity from your body and mind.

Many people will use breathing techniques to help them remain focused during meditation. This is when you close your eyes and start breathing normally. You want to focus on your breath. Notice on your clothes feel on your body or place one hand on your chest and your other hand on your stomach. Feel how your hands move as you breathe in and out. You will then focus on deep breaths. Take a deep breath in and then exhale slowly. Complete this exercise until you feel calm.

Meditation will not only help you eliminate manipulators who haven't become a close person in your life, but it will also help you manage your life with a manipulator. Of course, you want to leave if your significant other is a manipulator for your own mental health and safety, but meditation can help give you strength. It can give you the strength to focus on your mindset and find ways to protect yourself from the manipulative techniques. It can also give you the strength to leave, once you are ready.

Why Psychologists Study Dark Psychology

This is one of the biggest questions psychologists ask themselves when they are looking into manipulation. While asking why people manipulate for positive results is easier, looking at why people manipulate to emotionally and mentally harm someone is harder. However, this is what dark psychology is all about. You ask questions to learn why someone acts the way they do.

There are several reasons why psychologists study factors within dark psychology. One of these reasons is they are in the mental health profession. Their job is to try to figure out ways to help people, whether they are doing something good or bad. In order to help people psychologically, you need to be able to understand how their mind works.

Another reason they ask this question is to gain insight into how manipulation works. Psychologists ask themselves if there is something within the brain that works differently for people who use manipulation in a negative way. If there is, what is this? Does it have to do with the chemicals within the brain, is there a part of the brain that doesn't function correctly? Negative manipulation is often a symptom of various psychological disorders, which often cause differences in a person's brain function and reasoning.

Asking this question also allows psychologists to study manipulation so they can learn the strategies manipulators use and why. They can learn why people fall into the manipulator's trap. All of these factors help psychologists learn about humans so they can better help people who are in need of their services.

Chapter 2: Persuasion

Persuasion is the act of getting someone to believe or do something. Like manipulation, everyone takes part in persuasion sometime during their lives. Companies use persuasion in their ads to get people to purchase their product. Motivational speakers use their stories and other techniques to motivate their audience to better their lives. While you might persuade someone to help them accomplish a goal or better their life, many people use persuasion negatively for their own benefit. When persuasion crosses this line, it is known as dark persuasion.

Key Elements of Persuasion

There are several key elements that are involved in persuasion. All of these elements need to be accounted for in order to be considered an act of persuasion.

- When persuasion is used in a positive way, people remain free to choose what they want to do. Just because they support the product doesn't mean they will purchase it.
- Persuasion is more than words and images. You can also use symbols, music, and sounds.
- Persuasion is communicated in several ways, such as face-to-face, online forums, television, radio, and the internet.
- Persuasion has to include the motivation to influence other people.

Aristotle's Three Modes of Persuasion

Almost everyone has heard of Aristotle. He is one of the most well-known Greek philosophers of the classical period. While he is best known as “The Father of Western Philosophy,” he also developed three modes of persuasion: Ethos, Pathos, and Logos (“Ethos, Pathos & Logos – Modes of Persuasion (Aristotle)”, n.d.).

Ethos

Ethos is best known as the speaker’s personal character or ethical appeal. According to Aristotle, these characteristics should include empathy, competence, and good intention. Together, they make the speaker credible, which is the speaker’s main goal as they want to get the audience to listen to them.

There are several ways that the speaker can use ethos, such as language, grammar, clothing, and accomplishments. The speaker wants to use the best language for their audience. They need to choose the best vocabulary and speak at a level where their audience can understand them. For example, if they are discussing how to take apart a computer for beginners, they won’t use expert language as their audience won’t understand it. Furthermore, they will want to use correct grammar when speaking. The speaker is going to be more persuasive if they remain non-judgmental and unbiased with their comments.

Their choice of clothing will also tell the audience about the speaker's character. For instance, if the speaker wears jeans and a shirt, the audience might think they are laid back or unprofessional. If the speaker wears professional clothing, such as a suit, the audience will think they are professional, successful and take pride in their work. While some of this depends on the audience's personality, most people are more likely to be persuaded by a person dressed professionally than casually.

Another way the speaker is more persuasive is through their list of accomplishments. The audience is more likely to believe the speaker if they have extensive accomplishments in the field.

The audience is going to pay attention to the speaker's facial expressions, gestures, tone of voice, and body movement in general. For example, if a speaker doesn't move around the stage and fails to make eye contact, they are going to look less engaged. People might feel they are nervous, unsure of what they are talking about, or uninterested in talking to them. The audience likes to feel that the speaker is talking directly to them. Therefore, if the speaker maintains eye contact, walks around the stage confidently, and uses interesting and relatable facial expressions and hand gestures, the audience is going to be swayed by the presenter.

Pathos

When a presenter uses pathos, they are using their emotions to try to persuade the audience. This is a common factor among many speakers during some point of their presentation. Depending on what they are discussing, presenters might open with a personal story to reach their audience's emotions immediately. Other speakers will wait until later in

their presentation as they feel this engages the audience as they are becoming restless from sitting for so long.

Emotions are used so the audience can feel closer to the speaker. They feel sympathetic because they understand what the speaker went through. Another common emotion from speakers is to make their audience feel angry. Of course, this isn't toward the speaker, but toward someone else or a company.

The key features that effectively allow speakers to reach an audience through pathos are the emotional tone, language, and meanings. It is a lot easier to persuade someone through strong emotions because people often let their emotions guide their decisions.

Aristotle believed that it was essential for the speaker to know their audience. People tend to become emotional over certain topics. For example, if you are in a privileged community, most of the audience might not relate to topics pertaining to poverty or low-income housing. This is because many of them might not understand what it is like to live in poverty. While they might support a cause, you will have a harder time reaching some of this audience through emotion.

Logos

Logos is when the speaker uses reasoning or logic to reach their audience. In other words, the speaker will give an argument in order to win the audience over. This means that the speaker needs to be extremely knowledgeable about their topic. While passion toward the topic helps, this would be something the speaker would use for pathos over logos.

The audience who is persuaded by logos likes to hear facts. They don't often care for the emotional stories; however, you should always include a

couple. Aristotle stated there are two different forms of facts to focus on in your presentation: The first form is technical or artificial facts, which are developed through logic and information, such as examples; The second form is natural facts, which are based on testimonies, data, and other documents ("Ethos, Pathos & Logos – Modes of Persuasion (Aristotle)", n.d.).

How to Use Psychological Persuasion

Recently, Professor of Psychology and Marketing, Robert Cialdini published a book called *Influence: The Psychology of Persuasion*. This book discusses psychological persuasion, including six principles of persuasion.

1. Consistency

Once you have made a decision, you want to make sure to stand with that decision. You don't want to allow yourself to push aside your belief because someone else doesn't agree with you. If people realize that you can be easily persuaded by someone else, they will not be persuaded by you.

You shouldn't worry about being wrong as this is a part of life. You are able to grow mentally and emotionally when you are wrong. You want to admit you're wrong, accept it, and then learn from it. You can also take this a step further and establish a decision journal where you write down all of your decisions.

You can use this journal to analyze your decisions and thoughts. This will help you keep your mistakes in mind and help you analyze what steps led you to the wrong decision. For example, you might see that you felt rushed to make a decision. You might also feel that you were struggling with an area of your life and this influenced your decision. You can also write down if you were able to persuade someone with your decision.

2. Liking

You want people to like you. Take a moment to think about if you will be more persuaded by someone you like or don't like. Chances are, it is someone you like. This is because you have been able to establish a connection with them. You understand them, their decision, and feel that you can trust them. Therefore, you are more likely to listen to them and have a conversation with them about the topic. It is important to note that a conversation or friendly debate is often a way to persuade someone. It is a lot easier to communicate like this when you enjoy someone's company.

Not everyone is going to like you right away. Some people will as they are naturally trusting or like people until they have a reason not to. Other people, you will need to warm up to a bit. For example, you might want to find common ground, something that you both enjoy doing. You might play a game of tennis with them or you might go to a coffee shop.

It is often the little things that matter. For example, people who send others Christmas cards or birthday greetings are typically well-liked people. They go out of their way to make someone happy and show they are thinking about them. This is another great way to build a connection with someone.

3. Reciprocation

The more you do something positive for other people, the more they will give it back. Reciprocation is another way to gain the trust of people, get them to like you, and make them more willing to listen to you.

It doesn't matter what you give or do, what matters is that you do something good. The point is to make someone feel special and happy, even if it is only for a few minutes. When people feel special, they are more likely to remember you in a favorable way.

They will also want to return the favor, even if you tell them they don't have to. They will want to do this because it will make them feel good to help you.

Of course, you will also run into people who refuse to take the gift. This is their decision and you need to be respectful of it. After all, the more respectful and understanding you are, the more will-liked you will become.

4. Authority

When you are trying to persuade someone, you want to speak with authority. Make sure you are well-rehearsed in your topic as this will help you feel authoritative. Do as much research as you can and make sure you understand everything you are reading. If you don't, take the time to talk it through with someone who can help you.

Think about how often you listen to an authority figure, such as a police officer, doctor, or professor over a colleague or acquaintance. People who we see as authoritative can easily persuade us because we believe they are knowledgeable about what they are saying. We believe that because they have been educated in their field of study or give presentations on their topic often, that they are more knowledgeable than ourselves. In many ways, they are, but you also need to be cautious of who you are listening to. There are a lot of people who state they are experts in the subject they are speaking of but who are frauds.

5. Social Proof

Have you ever noticed that you are more likely to agree with someone if someone else does? Take a minute to think of how often you have waited to

speak up or raise your hand until you saw someone else do it. As Cialdini states, “we...use the actions of others to decide on proper behavior for ourselves” (Cialdini, 2006).

While this can cause problems, such as if there is an emergency, it can also be helpful for many people. People who want to persuade you to believe or do something will fall back on social proof. For example, if they know that a couple of members in their audience are starting to understand and believe what they are saying, other people around them will too.

6. *Scarcity*

Another way to persuade people is to give them something that isn't common. For example, you can give them something that you know isn't sold around their area. You can also sell something with a sticker that states “Limited edition” or “Limited supply.”

Scarcity is a tactic that many businesses use. For example, have you ever been shopping on Amazon and read that there are only two or three of the items that you want left in stock? Does this make you purchase the item a bit quicker, especially if it is close to the holidays or someone's birthday?

There have been psychological studies which focused on how well scarcity worked to persuade people into purchasing something. In 2011, researchers Burger and Caldwell performed a study which proved that other than stating an item is for “limited time only” or “in short supply,” you can also state that something is “unique.” (Nicholson, 2018).

In this study, Berger and Caldwell would tell some participants they were invited to participate in a study because they had unique personality characteristics while other people were told they had common personality characteristics. Those who were told they were more unique often came

back for further studies while most from the other group did not return (Nicholson, 2018).

Psychological Persuasion Techniques

Foot in the Door Technique

There are a lot of techniques that people use for manipulation and persuasion. One of these techniques is the foot in the door strategy. Whether a person is using it for persuasion or manipulation, it works in the same way. They typically start with some small talk to a small favor and then take a bigger step in front of the door. Like manipulation, people who use persuasion want to get you committed to doing something for them.

Once the person feels they have their foot in the door, meaning you can't close the door, then they will ask a bigger favor. For example, someone you just met at the bar might ask you if you would call a taxi for them because they don't feel well. After you hang up the phone, they ask if you will stay with them as they wait for the taxi. Because you are concerned about the person, you agree. The person then asks if you would follow them home once the taxi arrives to make sure they get into their home safely. As you can see, the person continues to increase their requests. Psychologically, once you start saying "yes" and helping, you will feel you need to continue to help them. After all, people don't just stop helping someone, especially if they don't feel well or need help.

In reality, what the person did was persuade you to go to their home. They knew that you wouldn't agree if they straight out asked you "I don't feel well; will you make sure I get home alright?" At this point, you might make sure they get some type of help or a way home, but you won't offer to

do this as you are uncomfortable. You just met this person and even though you enjoyed their company, you are not comfortable going to their home.

Door in the Face Technique

The door in the face technique is opposite of the foot in the door technique. Instead of starting off the request small and then asking for something bigger, they ask for something bigger and then something smaller. Like the manipulator who follows a similar technique, the person trying to persuade you knows that you will probably say no to the bigger request. But, because you said no to the bigger request, you are more likely to say yes to the smaller request.

Unlike the manipulator, the persuader won't necessarily want the smaller request. To the persuader, it is a way to get into your mind. They typically plan on asking for a bigger favor later, they just need to persuade you a little more to get you to this point.

Use Powerful Words

The words you use when you are persuading are important. You want to use some of the most powerful words for your topic that you can come up with. In general, this has the same mindset that manipulators will use when they focus on keywords.

When looking at powerful words, you want to look at words that will influence people. The trick is to not overuse the words. You want to strategically place the words in throughout your speech.

Persuasive People Will Use Repetition

One of the biggest ways persuaders get you to do what they want is through reaching into your subconscious mind. For instance, if a company wants you to purchase a certain product, they will repeat the same advertisement every half hour during a movie on television or place it several times in a magazine. They will pay for advertising through social media, which means you will randomly see it on your Facebook timeline, Twitter, or Instagram. When this happens, you are more likely to remember the company and the product. After repeated exposure, this will make you more likely to think of trying and purchasing the product.

Commitment

Take a minute to think about someone who tried to commit you to do something. This could have been going to church services more regularly, taking a work day for a coworker, going to the gym, purchasing a product, or trying to change your mindset. No matter what it was, why did you commit? Did you commit because the person persuading you was committed to the task and seemed to enjoy it?

When we see that other people are committed to something and enjoying the outcome, we are more likely to become committed, just by being asked. While we might originally sound like we are unsure or we need to think about it, the persuader will continue to show their commitment. Typically, through more committed persuading, people are more likely to join in.

Another way persuaders use commitment is to get you to commit to something smaller first. This is similar to the foot in the door technique, however, it tends to happen more over time. In a sense, once you agree to commit to their first task, they believe they have you in their net. However,

they also realize that they can't overstep their bounds, or you will climb out of their net. Therefore, they hold you there until they feel enough time has passed and then ask you to commit to a similar task. Because you did the first task and it has been a while since you helped the persuader, you are more likely to commit to the second task.

It's Your Choice

Sometimes when people are being persuaded to do something or think a certain way, they will start to feel bombarded by the persuader. This makes them feel that they no longer have a choice and if they want the persuader to leave them alone, they will agree to do whatever the persuader is asking them to do. However, this crosses the persuasion line and into manipulation. When you are trying to persuade someone to do or believe something, you don't want to manipulate them.

It is important to realize that you don't have to become aggressive to make people feel this way. You can make them feel like they are backed into a corner by giving them too many reasons, continuing techniques when they are becoming uncomfortable, or constantly talking.

One of the ways to handle this technique when you start to notice your audience is getting anxious is by reminding them that it is their choice. You are simply here to give them the information they need in order to make an informed choice. Another way to do this is by saying "Of course, the decision is all up to you" while you are speaking. For example, if you are close to telling them that they need to purchase the item, then you will want to add "Remember, the decision is all yours" as this will help ease their feelings of being forced to make the decision you want.

“Even If” Technique

Persuaders who use this technique understand one fact, that most people think they are better than other people. No matter what we consciously tell ourselves, mostly because most of us believe this thinking isn't right, our subconscious mind feels a different way. Our subconscious mind knows that we are special and unique, we are different from everyone else.

Using this natural thought, why would you want to buy a certain product? Take a moment to think about how often you are thinking of purchasing a product and then decide not to because you aren't sure it will work for you. We usually think this way because we believe we are better than the product.

The “even if” technique is a technique a persuader uses to say, “This product will help you in this way, even if you don't believe you need it.” In other words, they are telling you to give this product a try because this product helps everyone, no matter how special and unique you are.

Try to Get Them to Laugh

Take a moment to think back to a time when you were in an uncomfortable situation but started laughing because of a joke someone said. You probably notice that this made you feel a bit better about the entire situation. You started to feel a little more comfortable and you started to like people you didn't know before.

Laughter is the best medicine is a true phrase. There are a lot of benefits that people get from laughing. One of these benefits is it reduces your stress. If you are uncomfortable, your body is going to naturally feel stressed, which you will need to reduce in order to feel better about your

situation. Another benefit is it gives you a sense of well-being. When we start to feel better about ourselves, we feel better about our situations.

Laughter will also help people open up. Therefore, they will be more willing to look at what you are trying to get them to do, ask questions, and become more interested in general. They will start to trust you, which will help them believe in what you are saying.

The Us vs. Them Technique

One of the biggest factors that persuaders know you need is to feel like you are not alone. Your persuader needs to get you to believe that you have similarities. They need to take you out of the “us vs. them” mentality and get you into the just “us” mentality.

Take a moment to think about this, how likely are you to follow someone you feel is similar to you than someone who is completely different? Most people are more comfortable and open when they realize there are similarities between them and the other person. Therefore, they will start to let down some of their walls and start to really listen to what the person is saying. To a persuader, this is letting them in the door.

The main reason for this is because you start to trust the person you share an identity with. This could be anything from growing up in the same state, going to the same college, enjoying the same movies, music, or having a similar upbringing. Sharing an identity with someone makes you feel like you are not alone. When you feel this way, you are more likely to respond positively to the person.

The Curiosity Gap

One of the biggest things advertisement agencies understand is the need to create a curiosity in order to get people interested in their product. They need to catch a person's attention to curiosity and hold a person's attention through curiosity. When you focus on the curiosity gap technique, you are doing both.

Persuaders know that you are more likely to agree to do something if you are curious about it. Therefore, they will often ask you to do something for them that they know you will enjoy. Some persuaders are masters with this technique and after they have gotten you to do something, they will give you a cliffhanger that is going to keep your attention. A great example of this is a series of books or a television series. If the final television episode of the season is left with unanswered questions, such as does that character get married or move, you are more likely to watch the next season. You will pay attention to when the television show comes on again in a few months instead of forgetting about it. On top of this, once you start watching again, you will continue to watch.

Give Your Audience the Reasons Why

People will want to know why they should purchase the product you are talking about or follow your beliefs. They want to know how it will help them in their daily lives. Persuaders know that no matter what their request is, as long as they give someone a reason, they will be more likely to follow through with the request.

There have been several studies that prove giving a reason makes people more understanding. For example, Psychologist Ellen Langer showed in her study that when people waiting for the copy machine asked, "I have five pages. May I use the Xerox machine because I have to make

some copies?”, over 90% of them were able to jump ahead in line to make their copies (Ye, 2017). Langer believed that by giving the reason as to why they needed to use the copy machine, people were more likely to allow the participants to skip ahead in line. It didn't matter that they had copies to make as well. Of course, this could have been because the participants had fewer sheets of paper while other people had more.

The trick that is hard for many persuaders to learn is when to use reasoning. There will be times where you use reasoning that is going to seem ridiculous, which won't help you persuade anyone. This can make your persuasion efforts too noticeable, which can backfire on you.

Persuasion, Language, and the Body

Through the psychological persuasion techniques, you probably realized how you talk, your tone of voice, your facial expressions, and your hand gestures influence a person's thoughts and emotions.

People who professionally persuade others for various reasons are mindful of their words and their actions. When you are mindful, you are aware of your behaviors, your thoughts, and your environment. You don't allow your mind to wander, known as mindlessness, because you will become less persuasive. Becoming mindful is a necessary skill which persuaders learn through various techniques.

Mindfulness Techniques

To help build their persuasive techniques, many people will start with becoming more mindful. This is something that they will practice throughout their day and not just when they are trying to persuade someone.

1. Take a minute to focus on mindful breathing.

Mindful breathing can take place anywhere. All you have to do is focus on your breathing. First, you will start to inhale and exhale slowly. Breathe in through your nose and then exhale out of your mouth. You should do this for about 10 seconds. Now, let your thoughts come and fall with your breathing. It doesn't matter what your thoughts are. They could be things you need to do today, what you forgot to do yesterday, what you feel bad about, or what you feel happy about. Whatever they are, you need to let each thought come with a breath and leave out of your body as you exhale.

Take a few seconds to focus on your breathing. Notice when their air enters your body and when it leaves.

2. Take time to become aware of your surroundings during daily tasks.

There are a lot of actions and tasks that we do which we do not think about. Take a moment to think of your movements as you are getting a glass of water or opening a door. These tasks we do so often that we take them for granted. We always believe that the door will open for us and always know we can get a glass of water. We are often thinking about other things than our actions.

Therefore, the next time you are doing something that you take for granted, stop a moment and notice your surroundings. Once you grab that glass from your cupboard, stop and look around at what is going on. Notice the sounds in the room, how warm or cold the room is, how you are standing, how you grab the glass, and anything else. All of these things will help you become more mindful of your surroundings.

3. Don't focus on what you are going to do once you complete the task, focus on the task at hand.

There is always a chore that we have to do which we don't care to do. For example, you might dread unloading and loading the dishwasher. When you have to do this chore, you will rush through it, listen to music, or focus on something else so you can get done with the chore without thinking too much about it.

The next time you are trying to rush through your chores, stop and focus on everything that you are doing. If you are unloading the dishwasher, focus on what you grab, how you grab the item, and how you put it away. Focus on if you check each item to make sure it got clean or if you have re-wash it. If you re-wash the item, focus on how you do this. Focus on how you rinse off the dishes and load the dishwasher. What muscles are you using,

how are you breathing, what are your thoughts, and do you deal with interruptions?

4. Take time to become mindful of the objects which are in your environment.

You can take time to do this exercise at any moment and with any object. All you have to do is pick an object to focus on. Observe the object for a couple of minutes. Try to notice everything you can about the object. It doesn't matter how long you have looked at the object or how often you walk by it. You want to view the object like you have never seen it before. Take your time to connect with the object.

You: The Persuader

Once you have started to become more mindful in your life, becoming more mindful of your actions, tone of voice, and body gestures are going to be easy. You will start to notice how often you talk with your hands and how they move. You will start to notice if you move your hands in certain ways and with what words. You will start to notice if your voice becomes louder with some words or topics than others. You will be able to learn if you are truly being persuasive when communicating with other people and how persuasive you are.

Most people think they have to put on some type of persona when they are trying to persuade people. However, people are more likely to become persuaded when you act naturally. People are more willing to listen when someone acts like a friend to them. If you act like you are more knowledgeable or better than them, they are going to feel that they are a waste of your time.

You also want to be honest. As a persuader, you will learn to answer negative questions in a positive way as this will gain better results. People are going to respond better when you speak positively than negatively. For example, if the company you are trying to sell a product for was recently in the news for embezzlement and you are asked about this, you could respond in a way that emphasizes the company's resilience in overcoming this obstacle.

Keep in mind how close you get to someone. Many people are particular about their personal space. If you step in their personal space, they will back up a step or two. They will try to do this without you noticing unless they feel defensive. When you are mindful, you will notice the little steps they take, which means you have stepped into their personal space. Don't step closer to them if they step away, stay where you are. You don't want to overwhelm the people you are trying to persuade.

As a persuader, you will also want to know the secrets to body language. You will want to know how you can become powerful through your gestures or how you stand.

1. Pay attention to the person you are trying to persuade so you can mirror them. You want to do what they are doing as this will create a connection, which will make the person more interested in what you have to say. It can also make the person feel that they can do what you want them to do.

2. You want to make sure you display the proper posture. You want to stand up straight or sit straight. This shows that you are interested in having a conversation with the person. Of course, you want to continue to pay attention to their body language as you always have to keep mirroring in mind. However, you also don't want to look like you are uninterested or unprofessional, which is how slouching can often make a person look.

3. How the feet are pointing can say a lot about how the conversation is going. While you don't want to spend too much time on the feet as this can make you seem uninterested, (you always want to give the person as much eye contact as possible) you want to glance down a bit during the conversation. Notice how their feet are pointing. If they are pointing toward you, they are more than likely interested in the conversation. If their feet are pointing toward an exit, they are thinking about leaving. If you notice that their feet are pointing toward each other or they are fidgety, you are probably making them uncomfortable (Genard, 2016).

4. You want to keep your body open as this will tell people you are interested in conversing with them. This means that you don't want to place your hands in your pockets, be fidgety with your feet, or cross your arms. The more open you are with your body, the more comfortable people will be coming to talk to you. You also want to pay attention to how the other person is standing. If you notice they cross their arms or put their hands in their pockets, they could be uninterested in the conversation or nervous.

5. You always want to keep your hands in view of you and the other person. When you hide your hands, people can think that you have something to hide or are lying. Always be mindful of your hands and how you are using them as this is something the other person will notice throughout the conversation. Furthermore, never fear how many hand gestures you use throughout your conversation. We are meant to communicate with our hands. Therefore, the more you use your hands in communication, the more people are going to pay attention to what you have to say.

How the Mind Can Resist Persuasion

There are several techniques that your mind can use in order to resist someone's persuasion attempts. Furthermore, you can also use these techniques to overcome persuasion.

Is the Persuasion Restricting Your Freedom?

People who are trying to persuade you in a negative way will often restrict your freedom. Therefore, you want to be aware of this. Before you agree to anything, you want to simply ask the question "Is this going to restrict my freedom?" Even if you feel it will restrict you temporarily, you probably won't want to take part in it. Many persuaders, especially when they are doing something that is negative, will continue to come back to you once you do something for them.

Another factor to note is if the person mentions your freedom. Persuaders will try a lot of techniques in order to get you to do what they want. Therefore, they might try to use your amount of freedom against you, especially if they feel that they don't have as much freedom.

Counter-Argument

Another way to resist persuasion is to find a counterargument. No matter what the persuader is saying, find any gaps or holes that can give you an in to find an argument. Of course, you can always just argue the different points the person is saying. Sometimes you are able to get a sense

of what the persuader really knows about the topic and when they are just putting on an act.

You can also take your counterargument a step further and state that you are right. Persuaders don't like to feel like they are up against a wall when they are trying to persuade someone. Depending on how strong of a persuader they are, they might back down and find someone else.

You will also find that the more you speak up against the persuader, the more people will support you. Most people are often waiting for someone else to speak up before they do. There will rarely be a time that you are alone in your counterargument unless it is just you and the persuader. However, even if you do find yourself arguing with them alone, keep in mind that you are right, and you are doing what you believe in. There is never anything wrong with standing alone if you truly feel this is what you need to do.

Don't Be Afraid to Rebel Against Authority

Many people feel that when people speak with authority, they have no right to speak up or question the person. However, when you feel you are being persuaded, this is exactly what you should do. Think of it like this, if you are going to rebel against your parents' authority, you have the right to rebel against any other authority. Especially if it serves to protect you against persuasion.

When you are speaking up against the persuader, attack the person. Of course, not physically, but verbally. You don't need to be a bully, but let the persuader know that you won't tolerate any injustice or dishonesty toward other people or yourself. Question their authority on the topic. Don't be afraid to add anger or irritation into your tone, it will only make the

persuader a bit more nervous, which is when they will most likely start to show their true colors.

Remember You Can Always Back Out

First, if you do get caught up in the web of persuasion, don't feel bad about it. This happens to everyone during one time or another. Instead, focus on whether you made the right decision and if you should back out or not. Take a moment to think about what you agreed to and how comfortable you are with the decision. If you find that this isn't something you want to do, then back out from it. No one can truly force you to do anything you don't want to do. It is always up to you. Don't feel bad about backing out from a persuasive agreement. You need to focus on how the actions are going to affect you.

You will also want to use this opportunity as a learning experience. Think back to the conversation and ask yourself how you were persuaded to do something. Did the persuader give you a compliment? What techniques did they use that worked on you? It always helps to write this information down in a journal or somewhere else so you can always look back on it when you need to.

Prepare for the Persuasion Attempt

Sometimes we will know that a persuasion attempt is coming. This can happen during political rallies, advertisements, going to see a public speaker or any other setting. You might also realize that the person you are talking to is trying to persuade you into doing something because you recognize the attempts.

When you notice these attempts, do what you need to, so you don't fall victim to the persuasion. Remember, that persuasion is also known as peer pressure. For example, if someone tells you "Come on, everyone is doing it. You don't want to be the only one left out" they are trying to persuade you into doing something you probably don't want to do.

Don't Listen to Them

While you might come off as rude if you do this in person, walking away or refusing to listen to the persuader is often your best defense. This is often easier when you are watching television and find yourself being persuaded to watch a show or movie that you are normally not into. You can simply shut off your television or change the channel. However, when you are face to face with the persuader, this technique can become harder.

Of course, you always want to pay attention to your environment and why you are there. You will probably not want to walk out of the room if you are listening to the persuader for work purposes. However, this would be a great time to use other resistance techniques, such as counterarguments. You can always make up an excuse to take time away from the persuader, such as needing to use the bathroom or check on your children.

You can also continue to listen to the persuader but refuse to follow with their requests. While you are listening, you can let your mind wander to different directions, such as thinking of what you will make for your evening meal or what other tasks you need to do that day. You will want to make sure that you spend some time focusing on the conversation, so you can ask questions, but you don't want to become heavily involved as this will make you more likely to become persuaded.

The Power of the Word “No”

We can all say it. We have all said it in our lifetime. We are quick to say it when we don't want our children doing something they shouldn't, or we don't want to do something. The word “no” is very powerful and can work as a technique to resist persuasion.

You will want to be aware that the persuader will probably try to change your mind through one of their many techniques. However, you can easily just keep repeating the word “no” to any of their requests. If you are caught up in an advertisement, simply tell yourself “No, I don't need this” and walk away or focus on something else.

Chapter 3: Mind Control

Another focus in the field of dark psychology is mind control. This can be a part of both manipulation and persuasion as both tactics reach inside of your mind and try to get you to do something, believe something, or follow someone else's path for you.

For many people, mind control can mean different things, such as manipulation, persuasion, influence, and brainwashing. For the purposes of this book, we will look at mind control as a way to change a person's thoughts, beliefs, and to control their actions.

One of the most famous psychologists of the 1970s, Philip Zimbardo, stated that mind control "is a process by which individual or collective freedom of choice and action is compromised by agents or agencies that modify or distort perception, motivation, affect, cognition and/or behavioral outcomes" ("Mind control explained - the dangers and how to protect yourself", n.d.).

Many people believe that mind control is one of the most well-hidden forms of influence because most people are not even aware it is happening. It is also a very slow process, which makes it harder for people to notice. People who are under mind control will feel that they are making their decision, but these decisions are actually being made by someone else.

You also need to be aware that the length of time it takes to control someone's mind depends on the techniques that are used, their personality, personal factors, and social factors. Sometimes, mind control can occur because of physical force.

Like manipulation and persuasion, mind control is used in our everyday lives. We usually are unaware that the techniques advertising agencies use

are a form of mind control. However, when they are able to get us to believe that their product is the best, this is exactly what they are doing. This doesn't mean that you need to always be aware of what the advertisement companies are doing, though it might help you save money. The mind control you need to be aware of is the type which is dark in nature. The type that follows people like Adolph Hitler or Charles Manson. You need to be aware of mind control when it can harm you in a negative way. Of course, paying attention to advertisements is a great way to practice how to guard yourself against mind control and to catch what type of techniques are being used.

Ways You Can Control People or Be Controlled

People who want to control your mind can use any of the following techniques or strategies that fall under manipulation or persuasion. One of the most important factors to remember is people who control others are great at reading people. They can usually tell what type of person they are dealing with pretty quickly. This helps them know what type of strategy they can use and which one they can't. This also helps them know what type of person you are. They need to know if you have a lot of emotional and mental strength as this can make their job harder. They also need to know if you have high self-esteem or are easily influenced.

Behavioral Modification and Conditioning

Behavioral conditioning, also known as modification, is the means to get people to do what you want. You do this through a series of rewards and punishments. It is often used in parenting classes and psychology courses in college. Before I go any farther, you need to understand that behavior modification is the act of changing someone's behavior. When the person consistently follows the behavior they were taught, it is known as behavioral conditioning. Behavioral modification will always come before behavioral conditioning.

People who want to take control of your mind excel at behavioral modification. This is because they need to modify your behavior in order to condition you, which is when they fully have control. The behavior mind controllers will choose to modify and condition first is going to be small. They will then continue to look for small characteristics, but gradually

increase the behaviors. They need to make sure that resistance towards the changing behaviors is minimal, otherwise they will find themselves struggling with conditioning. You might also catch on to their mind control tendencies and do what you can to put a stop to it.

The trick for any mind controller is they need to realize that behavioral modification only works to change the behavior. It doesn't work to change to motive. Therefore, they usually need to use techniques in order to work towards changing a person's motive for the behavior. If your motives don't change, then you are more likely to take part of the behavior again, even if they did condition you not to.

Belief Change Processes

One of the biggest keys to change someone's mind is you need to focus on changing their belief processes. This means that you not only change their belief, you change the reasoning behind it. What made them believe that gun control was important? You need to look at the steps their mind took when they decided to make that decision.

One of the biggest subjects that mind controllers are good at is psychology. A mind controller will study the way their target thinks, so they can get better control of their thought processes. This helps them open a doorway into controlling their target's mind. Of course, this makes therapists one of the best examples when it comes to mind control. However, therapists are trying to help their clients change behaviors so they can better their lives. Mind controllers want to change their target's behaviors so they can gain more control and power over the person. This is an example of how mind control can be used positively and negatively.

You can change a person's beliefs through giving them various examples or pictures. This is often how therapists work to change someone belief process. For instance, if you feel you can't go back to college to get your degree because you are too old, you will be asked to imagine your belief. Put you in your too old state.

Then you will be asked to imagine a positive outcome if you do decide to go back to college. Do you see yourself getting the job of your dreams? Do you see yourself making the Dean's list? There are a lot of questions you could be asked in order to imagine the positives.

You will then focus on something that isn't true anymore. You might feel that your previous too old state is what isn't true. Now that you have imagined yourself in your dream job, you are starting to believe that you can accomplish going back to college, no matter what your age is. This is the belief that they can learn at any age.

Next, you will want to organize the images. You will put the I am too old image into the category which is no longer true. You will then put your image of you succeeding in college and your career into the you can learn at any age category.

Covert Belief Changes

You don't need to use images in order to get someone to change their beliefs. Most mind controllers, who are trying to manipulate you so they can gain the upper hand, will not focus on images. This is because you will catch on too easily, especially at first. This doesn't mean they will never put certain images in your head. It just means that they tend to focus more on covert belief changes.

Mind controllers will need to make sure that they have your trust, respect, and a connection with them. Without these factors, they will not be able to successfully change your beliefs. They are also skilled at anchoring. This is because they realize that emotions are often a strong guide for people, especially when they don't know how to control their emotions. For people who can maintain their emotions well, mind controllers will struggle to become successful through this strategy.

The first step for the mind controller is to engage you in a conversation that will lead you to the behavior they want to change. When they do this, they will try to be subtle in their efforts. They won't act like they want to change your behavior directly. However, they could mention how it made them feel as this will elicit an emotional response from you.

Once you give them emotion, they will pull out the anchoring technique. Whatever behavior they want you to change, they will subtly show you what you should be doing. While this might not work immediately, you will start to change your behavior. Every time you do what your significant other feels is wrong, you will remember how you felt when you were talking. Over time, you will stop taking part in this behavior more and more because it gives you a negative feeling.

Rewards and Consequences

It is sometimes hard for adults to grasp the idea that they receive rewards and consequences for their actions, but they do. In fact, this happens several times a day, but we rarely take notice of it. For example, if you complete a task, your supervisor will congratulate you. If you are unable to complete the task by the deadline and need to ask for an extension, you will hear the disappointment in their voice. This will create a

negative consequence, which will make you more aware of time management. Therefore, you will be more likely to make deadlines in the future.

Mind controllers will also follow the rewards and consequence system. Sometimes, they are not as subtle when they do this because they want you to become emotional. For example, if you go out with your friends when your significant other told you they didn't really want you to, they will give you the silent treatment for a couple of days. This will make you realize that they are disappointed in you, which will make you disappointed in yourself. While you might not understand why they are doing this as you just went out with a couple of friends, your emotions will guide you more than your thoughts. The next time your significant other tells you they would rather you stay home than go out, you are more likely to think about staying home. Of course, this doesn't mean you will.

Mind controllers will often use rewards when you take part in the behavior that they want. For example, if you do stay home instead of going out, they might make it worth your while. They might decide to treat you to a dinner and a movie. They might also reach into your emotions by telling you how happy they are that you chose them over your friends. They might say something like "You make me feel so loved." This reward will stick in your mind, especially the comment made by your significant other as you want them to feel loved and cared for, not abandoned.

The I to You Shift

This is something that is common in regular conversation, which means it can be hard to spot. However, people who are trying to control your mind

will often shift their story onto you. This means that instead of saying “I” they will say “you.”

There are several reasons for this. One of the reasons is because it gives you two a sense of connection. This is something that writers often use to connect to their audience, in a positive way. However, when it comes to mind control, this is used in a more negative way. Mind controllers who want to chip away at your self-confidence will use “you” when they are discussing a negative story, one which can put you in a bad light. Even though you know you didn’t do this, and you are not actually part of the story, it goes into your subconscious mind and can make you believe that you did something similar in your life. Therefore, what you are feeling toward the person in the story is actually what you are feeling toward yourself.

Stalking

Mind controllers and manipulators often find their targets through observation. They typically have a type, such as people do when they are looking for a significant other. Their type might be someone who is sitting quietly in a corner or someone who is trying to hide their body because they are self-conscious. Once they find their target, they will spend more time observing them as it gives them leads on what strategies and techniques to use.

While most people would consider this a form of stalking, it is all part of their compulsion. The reality is, it does generally fall under the category of stalking. This is because many people are known to find out where the person lives and gain any information they can about the person’s life. They will also not be shy that they know these things about you. For example,

they might show up on your doorstep because they are having car trouble and their phone is dead. They might also send you flower to your home or work address. They might start to ask you about how your kids are doing or if you enjoy your job.

While most people start to find this concerning, they tend to answer the questions because they are caught off-guard. This means that they might answer the questions without really thinking about it or they might come to believe that the person does care about them because they are going out of their way to get to know them. While there are several love stories that start out like this, there are also several bad relationships that start out this way.

The bottom line is, you always want to be careful about what questions you answer and what information you give out. If you start to feel that you are being stalked, let someone know. You can let your family and friends know along with the police. You always need to do what you can to protect yourself because safety is number one.

They Will Think for You

People who want to control you mentally will have no problem starting to think for you. Their trick is often they will first start to make a decision for you where it really doesn't matter. You might be discussing something and tell them, "I'm not sure what I think. Let me think about it." This is an open door to someone who wants to control your mind. This tells them that you need help making a decision. Therefore, if they step in to subtly make the decision for you, it isn't going to bother you.

They will usually tell you something like "I know you are stressed with everything else, so why don't you let me make the decision and we will talk about it." Then, to seem like they took time to make the decision, they will

come to you a bit later with their answer. Of course, they will act like you have a choice or act like they care what you think about their decision. However, you really don't have a choice. They are just trying to get you to trust that they can make decisions for you.

They will then start making more decisions for you, without your permission. However, you won't pay much attention to these decisions because they really aren't too important. Then, they will stop asking you to think about anything. This is typically when they start to limit your decisions, however, you still might not notice immediately because you have started to become used to them thinking for you.

They won't start with drastic decisions such as what you are going to wear or what you are going to eat. They will start by giving you choices or doing something nice for you, so you didn't have to think to do it. For example, they might decide to pick the restaurants you eat at, though now and then they will pick your favorite. They might decide to start putting the clothes away for you. This is when some of your clothes might go missing or you start putting away clothes their way.

Embedded Commands

Embedded commands are messages that are sent to our subconscious. We don't often realize this is happening, even though we hear the commands. This is because they often happen in very subtle ways. They can also occur through a regular conversation you are having with your significant other.

One of the key tricks of embedded commands is the tone of voice you use. People will tell a lot about how you feel through your tone of voice. They will be able to know if you are angry, being sarcastic, or if you are

sad. This emotion will be embedded with the message and will tell the person how something makes you feel. If something makes you angry, they will remember this and be less likely to take part of the action.

You can also use embedded commands through written word. When you emphasize phrases through italics, bold, or by using all capital letters, you send a message to the person that what they are reading is important. For example, if you want your children to make sure they do their chores, you might make a note that says, “You have to **load the dishwasher** and **rinse out the sink** before you start playing on your Xbox.”

Meta Programs

Meta programming is how people take in the information they are given. Just because you say something a certain way, doesn't mean the person is going to perceive the message the same way. People often rate information they are given by importance. Therefore, if you give your children a long list of chores, they will look at the list and decide what needs to be done first. They might also rate the list through what they enjoy doing more to what they don't like to do.

There are several meta programs that people use in their subconscious mind.

1. Towards Meta Program

People who use the towards meta program are motivated to get a task completed. For example, if you give them a list of chores, they will want to complete every chore on the list. They will have a reason for becoming determined to complete the task. This could be anything from they want to play on their Xbox to respecting their parents by listening to them. Of

course, adults will work in the same way. When people are in a romantic relationship, they will want to show their respect to their significant other by doing what pleases them. This always gives a mind controller a step up, especially when their significant other is a person full of determination.

2. Away from Meta Program

Away from is opposite of towards. When people use the away from, they do not have the motivation to complete the task. Think of them as moving away from what they have been told to do.

When a mind controller is looking to see if they should use the away from or towards technique, they will often ask the person what is important to them. This will give them a direct answer to the technique without having to observe the person. It is easy to tell when someone has a lot of motivation and when someone is lacking drive.

3. Procedures Meta Program

People who follow the procedures meta program already have the motivation they need. They also have a set way of doing tasks. An example of someone who uses the procedures meta program would be a perfectionist. They want things to be done a certain way because this allows them to know that they were done perfectly.

This type of program can be tough for a mind controller to take over, simply because people are more cautious about what they are doing. Because they want to get something done a certain way, they don't often like to give control to someone else.

4. Options Meta Program

People who follow the options meta program are creative. They like to innovate ideas and they are always willing to try something new. This often leaves them open for someone who is a mastermind controller. Because they want to hear someone else's ideas, they will listen to the controller. When the controller uses forms of persuasion and manipulation, they will like the idea the controller brings more.

They Believe They Are Doing You a Favor

People who are making decisions for you and working to control your mind will believe, and make you believe that they are doing you a favor. This is easy at the beginning because they do often find ways that help you. For example, they will try to limit the amount of stress, or decisions, you need to make during the day. While you feel they are being helpful, you might also start to question their underlying motive when they start to make more decisions for you. However, they will keep telling you that they are doing you a favor. They will also start sulking or becoming irritated when you don't believe that they are trying to help you.

Emotional and Mental Discomfort

People who want to control someone's mind will mentally and emotionally cause them some sort of pain or discomfort in order to take control and remain in control. For example, when police interrogate someone for a crime, they will often cause them discomfort mentally and emotionally. They are trying to get the person to admit what happened and any wrongdoing.

Mind controllers can use any type of emotional or mental discomfort they see fit. They will often pick something strategically because they want to make sure that it will give them the upper hand. Some might try to back you in a corner while others will use your past to make you feel bad or worthless. The point is to cause you pain, but not physically.

Some will use this as a form of manipulation. This means that when they start to see that you are feeling the way they want, they will try to make you feel better. In your mind, this will give you a connection toward the person. You will start to trust them more, give them more information about yourself, and believe that they are trying to help you. Unfortunately, any information you give a mind controller is something that they can use against you.

Social Pressure

Social pressure is everywhere, which means it is easy for a mind controller to use it. They will do this strategically, as they will do with any other technique. You need to remember that one of the most important factors of a technique is the strategy that the controller uses. If they don't have a good strategy, or just use a technique with strategy, they will not be able to take control of someone's mind easily.

Many mind controllers will up their game when it comes to social pressure. The main reason for this is most adults are beyond the mentality that they have to follow social pressure, or they will lose their friends. However, controllers also realize that the more people who pressure any person, the more likely they are to give into the pressure. Therefore, many controllers will use the strategy of a mob in order to get into your mind.

One of the best examples of a social mob are social protests. These groups are a bunch of people who want the same thing. It doesn't matter how many people are in the group, what matters is how powerful the group is. This isn't to say that people who are protesting in groups are bad, many of them are doing something to help better the lives of others. However, think about how you are more easily influenced when there are a lot of people telling you the same thing.

Just because something is typically used for good, does not mean that you can't use it in a negative way. People who control your mind understand this. They also understand the power of social influence. They don't care if they are taking something that is typically helpful for society and using it in a negative way. Their goal is to control your mind as much as possible, especially if they are a narcissist, psychopath, and manipulator.

In order to use social mob control, they will gather a variety of people who want to pressure you. This is often what happens when people are in cults. The people understand there are certain steps which need to be taken in order to make the mob control work.

1. They have a clear outcome. They are typically not told of this outcome too far in advance. However, once they are informed, they agree to the plan.

2. Make sure everyone is gathered in one place and understands there is a shared experience. If members of the mob do not completely agree, this situation could easily backfire.

3. Make sure the group becomes emotional. Most people use anger to gain a response from the group and create a sense of unity. However, any strong emotion will work.

4. Make sure they all agree to the plan, once more. If you find people who are not sure about it, isolate them from the rest of the group.

5. Continue to escalate the mob as this is the ultimate step in gaining more members.

Neuro Linguistic Programming (NLP)

When it comes to mind control, NLP is one of the most common and contemporary systems. NLP as a technique of mind control which came about by accident. It was developed by psychologists who used the system in order to help their patients make better choices. The trick was, while the patients thought they were making their own decisions, it was actually the psychologists who were helping them make the decision. They often did this as a form of guidance.

People who want to control your mind will use the same process. However, they will often become more controlling as NLP goes on. This means that they will stop guiding you to your own decision and start making the decision for you.

There are several factors that go into NLP.

1. The mind controller needs to make sure they are paying attention

Sometimes mind controllers will become too confident in their abilities. This can make them lose focus on what they are doing, which can lead to their strategy falling apart. This can make people realize that the person is trying to control their mind and back away from them. Therefore, mind controllers will need to focus more on how the person is responding to their actions than if they are doing something correctly. When they follow the person's reactions, they are essentially following the person's lead. This will give them steps for their strategy so it will become more successful as the person is less likely to catch on to their controlling behavior.

2. The mind controller needs to make sure there is a rapport

When the controller builds a positive rapport with someone, they are able to make the person believe they care. Controllers want you to believe that they care about your feelings and thoughts. This will make you more comfortable. You will also feel like you can trust them more. Therefore, you are more likely to follow their guidance. Mind controllers will use several techniques in order to build a rapport, such as mirror your behavior and find common interests.

3. They will allow you to lead and then take over

Mind controllers who use NLP will use a technique known as pacing and leading. This means that they will allow you to ponder a decision. Then, when they start to feel that you are frustrated, they will jump in to help you. This is when they take the lead and will start to make the decision for you.

Anchoring

When people use anchoring, we connect an emotion to a gesture. For example, you have your favorite store because you feel like they treat you well. The staff makes you feel like you are important, which makes you more likely to shop at that store. Another example of anchoring is through commercials. Most are about 30 seconds long. Within that half minute, you will start to feel an emotion. By the end of the commercial, your emotion will be strong, and you will see the name or logo for the company. This will associate the emotion with that company.

When mind controllers use anchoring, they will watch your emotions carefully. Once they feel that your emotions are strong enough, they will bring in the object or thought which they want to anchor you to.

How You Can Unknowingly Give People Control

Sometimes we give people control of our minds without even realizing we are making it easy for them. There are several ways this can happen.

You Don't Take Care of Yourself

There might be times throughout the week that you don't take good care of yourself. These moments might fall on the weekend when you are trying to relax after a busy week and prepare for the next week. They also might happen in the evenings, especially if you have had a stressful day.

While you are just taking it easy and allowing yourself to relax as you prepare mentally for your next day or week, people who want to control your mind are going to see this as an open door. They are going to start their strategies around the times you are not taking care of yourself. First, they might show that they are being incredibly helpful by running a bath for you, doing your shopping, completing your errands, doing your chores, or making something for you to eat.

They will slowly start to make other decisions for you, whether they need to be made while you are trying to relax or during the day when you are at work. At first, this might be hard to spot because they are so helpful

during the times you are trying to relax. You might also try to tell yourself that their behavior is fine because they are helpful. By the time you start to notice a problem with it, you might feel that it is too late, or you might start to feel that the person is right, you do need help making the decisions.

Rebels Are Easily Controlled

Many people believe that rebels would be the hardest people to control. However, they are some of the easiest. This is because the rebels are often the ones who are monitored more closely. They are also people that others think need more help making decisions, so they can go on the “correct path” and “turn their life around.” When someone is a master at mind control, they often look for rebels because they know how much easier their job will be.

Many psychologists believe that subconsciously, rebels are asking to be controlled. They want an authority figure in their lives to tell them what they can or cannot do. Of course, they will continue to rebel a time or two, but that is when they want someone to correct their behavior and try to guide them on what they need to do. This is often something rebels won’t admit because they don’t realize this is how they feel.

You Are Afraid of Making Mistakes

If you struggle with anxiety and have a fear of making mistakes, you are more likely to come under someone’s control. This is because of the self-doubt you hold about yourself. It creates a doorway for mind controllers. Furthermore, you also tend to lack self-confidence and have more of a

negative self-image than other people. This makes it easier for people to control you mentally.

Of course, you won't mind the decision-making that the mind controller is doing. It might make you feel more comfortable as you don't have to make decisions by yourself. You will also feel that they won't make as many mistakes.

One of the best ways to close this door is to realize that everyone makes mistakes. You also want to realize that making mistakes is fine because it allows you to learn. The more you get into this mindset, the less likely you are to become controlled by someone else.

Asking for Guidance You Don't Need

Asking for unnecessary guidance is something that you will do for several reasons. One, is you might like the person. This means that you will ask them for help so you can spend time with them. You don't realize that what you are doing is allowing them to control your mind. Second, you have low self-confidence. You don't always trust the decisions you make so, similar to being afraid to make a mistake, you ask them to guide you.

While it is fine to ask for help now and then, you shouldn't ask for help on a consistent basis. This is asking for people to control you, even if this isn't your intention.

Inviting Controlling People into Your Life

You might be the person who doesn't mind being controlled. Therefore, when you meet someone who is willing to control your thoughts and actions, you are going to invite them in. You don't mind the control because

you have a desire to be controlled. You don't understand what this desire is, typically because it is a part of your subconscious, but you are aware of it.

You also might not realize how controlling the person is. You might feel that you are giving them some control, but they take more than you imagined. Of course, you might also do this unknowingly because you don't realize they are controlling.

You Struggle with Saying “No”

Some people struggle with saying the word “no” and you might be one of them. You might feel bad when you tell people you can't do something to help them. Therefore, you help them whenever they ask. This only makes you overextended on your duties, which is an open window for mind controller. Even if you don't realize you are letting them in, they will come in and make you believe they are helping you. While they will, they will also start to make your decisions, tell you what to do, and how to do it.

You Aren't Fully Aware of Your Emotions

You might push your emotions aside because you don't know how to handle them. You feel too deeply, or you were never taught how to handle your emotions. Unfortunately, when you are not fully aware of how you are feeling, a mind controller can easily and quickly step in. Even if you start to feel that they are taking control, this is an emotion you might push aside.

Another problem of not being clear of your emotions is you don't fully understand your values. This means you will struggle with making decisions. You will find you second-guess yourself and, sometimes, you are still not sure you made the right choice. This often causes you to dread

making decisions, which makes it easier for a mind controller. While you feel like they are helping you make decisions, they are setting you up.

Recognizing Mind Control

There are several strategies that can help you realize whether mind control is being used against you or not. Of course, one of the best ways is to do your research, understand mind control, and know the many techniques that people use.

Moody Behavior

People who are using mind control to try to get you to do what they want will often sulk or become moody when you don't follow their wishes. While this can often be a sign that your significant other is spoiled and used to getting their way, mind control can become a part of how they get their way.

The reason why this is important is that you will find that you are changing your behavior so you can stop your significant other from sulking. Any behavior that causes you to change your actions or responses is a sign of mind control. The more you change your behavior in order to please them, the more successful they are at mind control.

It is important to realize that this is a part of every relationship. If it doesn't harm you, such as your significant other sulks until you agree to eat at the restaurant he wants, then there is nothing to worry about. When you need to worry about mind control is when it becomes harmful or damaging to your mental, emotional, or physical health and well-being.

They Will Become Highly Critical of You

People who use mind control follow the “us vs. them” mentality. This means that they will look at all the people on the outside as “them.” When it comes to this mentality, they will believe that they are out to get both of you. This will often become one of the reasons why they are trying to isolate you from your friends and family.

The criticism comes in when you don’t follow their wishes and continue to associate with people, they don’t want you to. They will say things like you are stupid to associate with people who don’t care about you or them. They will also tell you that you don’t care about them if you continue to associate with people on the outside.

Another form of criticizing is they will continuously criticize the outside world. They will state that people who associate with them are special because they are better than anyone else. They will believe that they hold a superiority against everyone else and no one else will ever be as good as they are. This is the main characteristic of narcissism, a personality that often uses mind control in order to get what they want.

They Limit Your Choices

Another sign of mind control is that your choices are limited, or you simply aren’t allowed to make your own decisions. It doesn’t matter if it is deciding what to eat, where to go, or what to do, you are not able to decide alone. While your significant other might discuss your options with you, in the end, they are in complete control of what is decided.

There are several stories of people controlling their partner’s choice in clothing. Sometimes this is because your significant other doesn’t want you to wear certain clothes in public because they feel it isn’t what you should

wear when you are in a relationship. Other times it is because they want to know everything you are wearing, which means they might pick out your clothes for you. They will also make sure that the clothes they picked out are the clothes you are wearing, or you will have to deal with the consequences.

In more extreme cases, people are known to control when people can go to the bathroom, what food they can eat, who they can hang out with, and what job they can take. There are other cases where many people are not allowed to take jobs because their significant other forbids it.

There are several consequences that you will have to deal with if this is the type of limits you face. The basis is you will no longer think for yourself. You will lose your identity and start to believe that you can't make your own decisions. You will constantly second guess any decisions you do make and feel like they are the wrong choices. Therefore, you will find yourself calling your significant other often, asking them what choice you should make. Because mind control happens slowly, you will start to feel that this is just the way life is. You won't start to think that this behavior is not normal.

Other consequences are you will suffer from low self-esteem, you will lose your identity, and you will become isolated from your friends and family. While these consequences are negative for you, they are positive for the person who is controlling you. It makes their job easier.

You Become Increasingly Isolated

This is always a more recognizable sign if you are more extroverted than introverted. However, the emotions that you will start to feel through

isolation can tell you whether you are being mentally controlled or not.

People who want to control your mind will start by pushing you away from the people you aren't close to, at first. They will then start to isolate you from your close friends and family. Of course, you will probably be warned by people who see what is going on. However, you are less likely to listen to them as the isolation starts to sink in. This can happen because people who become isolated often fall into a depression. As humans, we need to have human communication and presence in front of us from time to time. If we are unable to get this, our mentality and emotions will start to suffer.

It is important to listen to the people who truly care about you. Even if it is hard for you to believe that your significant other is controlling you, listening and allowing them to help is going to give you an easier way out than pushing them away. While they will most likely be there when you need their help, the negativity on your mind and your emotions will weigh heavily on you for a very long time.

Self Defense Against Mind Control

Because mind control occurs slowly, you will probably face control for a period of time before you start to notice and try to escape from this environment. It might take you time to escape, depending on how strong the control is over you. For example, if your significant other has people checking in on you throughout the day, you will struggle to find an escape. You also need to get yourself to the right mindset before you escape. You need to want to escape and want a better life for yourself in order to follow through with the escape and stay away.

This means that you might have to use various self-defense tactics in order to protect yourself against more mind control. Of course, these techniques are great for people who are cautious about mind control and the need to protect themselves.

The best advice is to be careful when you are trying to escape someone who has control of you. Most people will do anything to make sure that you do not escape from their grip. Therefore, you could have a fight on your hands, which can easily become physical and legal. You will also want to be cautious about what type of strategy you use to fight off the mind control. You probably won't want to get your significant other to catch on to the fact that you are working on a plan of escape and understand how they have been controlling you.

Always Remain in Close Contact with Friends and Family

You are very aware of the people who truly care about you. You will want to make sure that you do everything you can to remain in close contact with them. While you might not always like to hear what they tell you about your significant other, you need to remember they want the best for you, more than the person who is controlling you. Your best friends and family will never be afraid to tell you if they notice someone is could potentially harm you, whether it is emotionally, mentally, or physically.

If you start to notice that your significant other is trying to keep you from the people you love and who love you, they are not good for you. You need to stand firm when you tell the person that you refuse to allow them to push you away from your family and friends. If they don't back down or try other mind control strategies, you have to walk out of that relationship.

Be aware, if you do walk away, the person is going to try to come back for you. People who use mind control do not give up on their significant other easily, especially if they have spent a lot of time teaching you to follow their directions. You will need to stand firm every time they contact you. Do what you can to not meet them anywhere alone and always keep your safety in mind.

Refuse to Acknowledge the Sulky Behavior

Another way to defend yourself from mind control is to refuse to put up with behavior that is sulky. Stand firm when you tell your significant other that this behavior is beyond you and them. Let them know that it is immature and childish, and you will not allow them to act this way with you.

Watch How Many Rules They Force You to Follow

While you can take advice from your close family and friends when it comes to the rules your significant other sets out for you, if it feels wrong, it probably is wrong. No one, not even your significant other, should tell you exactly what clothes you should or should not wear. They should not be telling you when you can or can't use the bathroom, what job you can have, or if you can even work at all. Above all, your significant other should not take away any form of your identity. If this is what they are trying to do through the rules, then you need to get out of that relationship as it will just become devastating for you.

Notice When Someone Is Mirroring You

One of the first signs that you are a target for a mind controller is they will mirror your behavior. It is important to remember that we are all individual people. Therefore, when someone is trying to act the same way you are, they have a motive. If you are unsure that they are truly mirroring you, test them. You can do this through a few hand gestures or by moving back and forth on your feet. They won't think that you have caught on to the mirroring, so they will continue to act the way you do. If you notice that they do nearly every movement the same way, you will want to back away from them. You can do this by stating you have to go or coming up with another excuse.

You should also note that if a person has more skill with mind control, they won't copy every moment you make as they know this is too noticeable for people. They might also realize that you are moving about

more than normal and start to back away as they feel you are catching onto their ways. Therefore, you want to try to be as skilled as they are. Don't make a bunch of movements at once. If you are talking, wave your hands a certain way every time you say a specific word or phrase. If you notice them doing this, when they weren't before, then you are probably being mirrored.

Change the Patterns of Your Eye Movements

When people are processing new information, their eyes move a certain way. People who take part in mind control, especially the skilled ones, know this so they will pay close attention to your eyes. Of course, they are typically able to do this easily because most people feel when someone is looking directly at their eyes, they are interested in what they are saying. While mind controllers do notice your words and phrases as this helps them understand your mind a bit more, they are more interested in the way your eyes move. Once they understand what your eyes say about the information you are processing in your brain, they are able to gain a better understanding of your mind.

While it is always hard to tell at first, if you start to notice someone paying close attention to your eyes and they have other signs of a mind controller, you will want to move your eyes differently. This might be hard for you at first as we are usually unaware of how our eyes move when we process information. The best tip to give you is to simply move your eyes around. Look to the left, the right, look up, and even look down. Move your head as you move your eyes sometimes. This will make it harder for them to learn what is going on inside of your brain.

Don't Let Anyone Touch You

Some people won't have a problem with this one as they don't like to be touched. Other people will as they don't mind feeling the human touch, even if it is from someone they don't really know. However, for general safety, it is always best that you don't let someone touch you unless you know them. Of course, there are exceptions to this rule such as shaking hands with someone you just met or giving someone a hug at a funeral in order to comfort them in their time of loss.

What you need to pay attention to is when you are talking with someone and your emotions are raised. For example, you are in a conversation and you start feeling angry about a social topic you are passionate about. As you are deep into the conversation and your anger rises, the person gently taps you on the shoulder. While they can use the excuse that it was a way to try to get you to relax or feel better, people don't typically touch someone when they are feeling angry. This is a sign that they could be anchoring the emotion to the touch.

Always Pay Attention to Language and Tone of Voice

Mind controllers, along with manipulators and persuasive people, are going to use certain language and tones when they are trying to give you messages. You will want to pay attention to this as they will allow you to see how their minds work, just as they are trying to see how your mind works.

If you notice someone is being vague about what they are saying, they might try to be getting you into a trance, which will allow them to take

control of your mind. This trick works because when the message is vague, it is hard for you to react or form an argument, which leaves you open to a mind controller.

They will also give you permission to do things. While this seems to be opposite to what a mind controller wants, it is things that they want you to do. For example, if they want you to watch a movie, they might say “Watch this movie if you like” or “You have to watch this movie over and over again.” Both statements give you permission and allow them to hold control as you will more than likely watch the movie.

While you will want to watch the words and phrases they use, you will also want to listen to their tone. Many people, including mind controllers, are not always aware of the tone of voice they are conveying. Therefore, if you notice they are talking slyly or thinking about their words carefully, they could be distracted through your actions, eye movements, and how you are talking. If the tone doesn’t make you feel comfortable, chances are you should do what you can to keep them at a distance.

Keep People at a Distance

This is a strategy that is easier for some people as it can depend on the type of personality you have. For example, if you are an introvert, you are going to feel that you need to keep people closer to you because you enjoy the company of people. However, if you are an extrovert, you would rather keep people at a distance naturally. It is important to note that many mind controllers will gravitate toward extroverts because they are more outgoing, and this gives them the upper hand when learning their target’s personality. However, some like to gravitate toward introverts because they believe introverts have lower self-esteem. This is not exactly true. Just because

someone would rather spend more time alone does not mean their confidence is lower than someone who enjoys being around people.

However, no matter what type of personality you are, you should always be aware of the people you are meeting. This is just natural safety precautions as you don't want to put yourself or someone else in harm's way. therefore, it is always smart to keep people who you don't really know at a distance. For example, if you just met someone at the club, they don't need to know how many children you have, if you are in school, what you are studying, or what your hobbies are. Mind controllers will try to get you to open up quickly as this makes their process go a little faster. If you feel that the questions are invading your privacy or they don't need to know, you don't have to answer their questions. You can either push the conversation toward another topic or you can decline to answer.

Trust Your Intuition

We all have an intuition. The problem is we don't always listen to what our intuition is telling us. For example, if you are talking to someone you just met and you get the gut feeling of being uncomfortable or feel that something is off, you just can't put your finger on it, something is not right. Your intuition is trying to tell you that this person is not your friend, they want something that you shouldn't be giving them.

The problem with our society is we often feel this is overdramatic or doesn't give someone a chance. The reality is, our intuition is a strong force that works deep within us to help us make the right decision. No, it isn't always going to be correct 100% of the time. But it is also better to be safe than sorry.

Conclusion

There are many examples of manipulation, mind control, and persuasion in history. Some of the most infamous examples are Charles Manson, Adolph Hitler, and Ted Bundy. When you look at Charles Manson, you are able to get a profile of someone who was able to use his words and “love” for his “family” to create a cult. He was able to take young adults and make them into murders. You need to remember that Charles Manson never actually killed anyone. He simply had the members of his “family” do this through manipulation, mind control, and persuasion.

Adolph Hitler was the same way. He started by getting people to like him through persuasion. People believed that he would be one of the greatest political leaders of all time. While he did go down in history, it is not because he was a great political leader. It was because he used all the tactics discussed in the books to get people to believe Jews and people with mental and physical handicaps were worthless. He got people, some citizens and the Nazis, to believe that certain people had to be killed in order to make the world a better place.

Ted Bundy is one of America’s most notorious serial killers. During the 1970s, he raped and killed several females. He would often get the women to follow him because of his charisma, which is a personality trait that many manipulators and persuaders have. He was also known to be good looking and would act like he could be anyone’s best friend.

Today, psychologists continue to study the methods behind people like Charles Manson, Ted Bundy, and Adolph Hitler. One of the most famous psychological experiments to prove that people can be controlled through manipulation and persuasion is the Stanford Prison Experiment. In the early

1970s, psychology professor Philip Zimbardo used college students from his class to perform this experiment (Mcleod, 2018). He told some students that they were criminals and were locked up in prison. He told other students that they were the guards. Every student in the experiment had their assigned roles and understood what they were supposed to do.

The purpose of the study was to find out whether guards in the American prison system were ruthless because of their personality or because of their environment (Mcleod, 2018). Zimbardo played the supervisor of the prison and built a mock prison in the basement of the Stanford University psychology building. Before he agreed to let people play any role, he made sure they were mentally and emotionally able to handle this type of experiment by giving people a psychological assessment. Out of the 75 college students that applied, about 24 men were approved.

None of the participants knew each other and their roles were randomly assigned. By the time of the study, there were 11 prisoners and 10 guards. The prisoners were arrested in their own homes, without warning. They were then blindfolded and brought to the mock prison where they were searched and fingerprinted. They were treated like every other criminal.

The guards were given matching uniforms, billy clubs, and whistles. They were also given sunglasses, so they couldn't make eye contact with any of the prisoners. From the beginning, Zimbardo told the guards that they could not use physical violence to maintain law and order. However, they could do whatever else they felt was necessary. To Zimbardo's surprise, who believed real prison guards were cruel to prisoners because of their personality, the guards started to quickly become hostile to the prisoners.

Within hours, the guards started to harass the prisoners and make them do sit ups or pushups as punishment. They also started to increase their authority against the prisoners. This brought a surprise rebellion from the prisoners, who tore off their number badges and pushed their beds in front of the doors to their cells so guards could not get in (Mcleod, 2018).

This rebellion was the start of a changing relationship between the guards and prisoners. The prisoners became more submissive as the guards become more aggressive. Within a couple of days into the experiment, one prisoner started to suffer from emotional disturbance. When the parents came to visit the prisoners the next day, most prisoners introduced themselves by their prison number. Rumors started to spread of a mass escape plan, which is when Zimbardo started to look into what was going on a little more closely. He started to talk to the prisoners and inform them that they were not their number, that they had a name and an identity (Mcleod, 2018).

Less than a week into the experiment, it was terminated because the guards started to abuse the prisoners. On top of this, many prisoners were showing signs of emotional disturbance, which was making other psychological professors anxious about the experiment.

The conclusion of the Stanford Prison Experiment was that people will conform to social roles, especially in a heavy manipulated environment (Mcleod, 2018). People will also start to conform when other people try to persuade them to act a certain way, such as when a guard would get another guard to treat a prisoner harshly. People will also conform when they are being controlled, such as with the social roles and the environment. These are forms of mind control.

Through this book, you have learned what dark psychology really means. You realize that it is nothing to be afraid of. In fact, it can help you

in your daily life. You also realize that you have been manipulated, persuaded, and controlled through your mind many times throughout your life. While most people deal with these forms of dark psychology as a way to help them make better decisions, sometimes it is not for your own good.

You have become aware of the techniques people use in order to try to control or manipulate you. Because of this, you will feel ready to take on your next manipulator. You will feel that you understand what they are trying to do, which means you will be less likely to fall victim to their techniques. However, you always need to be aware of the strategies they will use that you do not understand. While I talked about the most common strategies within the three chapters of the book, this doesn't mean that they won't come up with their own strategies. While beginners will struggle with finding their own manipulative techniques, master manipulators will have enough experience to come up with their own.

What to Do If You Need Out

The bottom line is, using any of these dark psychology tactics negatively in a relationship is a form of abuse. If you are being manipulated or mentally controlled to the point it is hurting you physically, emotionally, or mentally you have to find a way to get out of the relationship. It is not going to be easy and you might feel that you are making the wrong decision. In fact, you might find yourself going back to your significant other after you leave them because, as you will get yourself to believe, “it wasn’t really that bad” and “They promised they would change.”

First, you need to realize that they are not going to be able to change overnight. In fact, it is going to take them years and a lot of counseling to change. If they truly want to change, which usually isn’t the fact, then you need to make sure they go to a counselor and recognize when behaviors change and when they don’t.

Second, though you might not feel it at this moment, you are able to get out. You do have support. Even if you have become isolated from your friends and family, there are always support groups, shelters, and non-profits who are willing to help you get your life back on track.

It will not be easy because you will need to get to the point that you start to build up your confidence again. You need to feel that you are not worthless, and that people want to help you. This is something that master manipulators and mind controllers try to take away from you as it gives them the upper hand and they feel that you will never be able to find your confidence again. However, you can prove them wrong. You can fight this, and you will come out on top.

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AUDIO SAMPLE

Would you like to Affect other People's Mind to Get What You Really Want?

Would you like to identify and Avoid those Toxic People that try to Manipulate Your Life in any way possible, pushing you to do what is good for them, but not for you?

Knowing the Art of Manipulation is the Secret to Success.

The only way to live a peaceful and truly **Free Life** is **Avoiding the Attempts to Manipulate** occurring **Every Day** to you at **Work**, with your **Partner** or with the many **Fake Friends who try to Exploit You**. But it is also important to know which are the **Psychological Tricks** to easily get from other people **Anything You Want** and **When You Want** it.

Dark Psychology and Manipulation is the **Ultimate and prompt Guide** to learn **How to Exploit the Art of Manipulation and Persuasion** in your everyday life through the **Most Secret Psychology Techniques**.

*At the end of this audiobook, you will be able to **Identify** and interpret other people's most intimate **Secrets, Wishes, and Fears**, and use this information **To Get What You Want from Anyone and in Any Context.***

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- The **26 Psychological Tricks** you can use in your everyday life **to Get Anything You Want**
- The secret to **Getting your Interlocutor's Attention** and making him or her willingness to **Comply with Your Requests**
- The **11 Most Effective Persuasion Techniques** and how to use them
- **The Most Effective Trick** to improve yourself and **Gain a Greater Persuasive Strength** towards others
- The **7 Mistakes you Make Every Day** and that make you **Easily Controllable**
- How to figure out if someone is trying to control your mind and **How to Stop Them**

*Although you may think that Manipulation is a tricky technique that you can't use for your benefit, thanks to **Dark Psychology and Manipulation** you will learn that **You too can Exploit the Darkest Side of Psychology** by following the **Techniques and Practical exercises** that you will find in every chapter.*

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